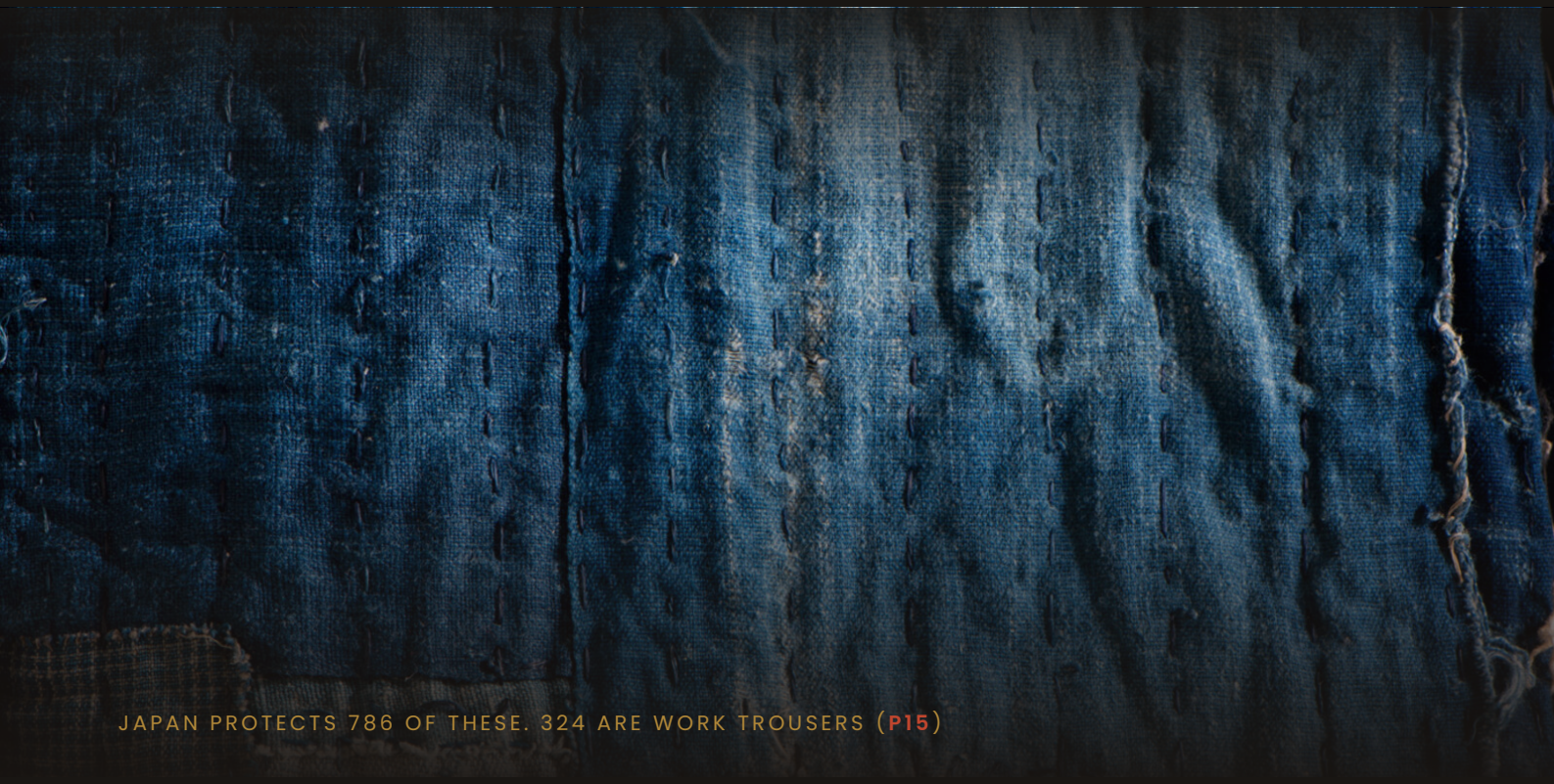
NO. 152 · SINGAPORE

THE CURRENT BRIEFING OF

MERIDIAN

Twelve desks. One world.

TUESDAY 3 NOVEMBER 2026



JAPAN PROTECTS 786 OF THESE. 324 ARE WORK TROUSERS (P15)

THE WORLD

Araghchi offers to reopen Hormuz in two days; Washington has not accepted, and oil fell anyway

TECHNOLOGY

Anthropic promises suppliers 895 billion dollars, running to the year 2045

THE LONG READ

Manila sells rice at twenty pesos and works to push the market price up

Source: the back of an indigo-dyed Japanese boro quilt showing functional and decorative sashiko, National Museums of World Culture, Sweden — Karl Zetterström, CC BY 4.0.

THIS ISSUE · NO. 152

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THE LONG ACCOUNT. It kept turning up. A compute bill that runs to 2045 against nine months of revenue (p7). A patch merged on its 129th day, and a fix unreviewed on its 126th (p8). A first number one after twenty-two years and four months (p11). A cohort followed for twenty-two years that found the late starters level with the never-stopped (p18). A haze law twelve years old with no fine to its name (p5). And a rice subsidy funded precisely to the last day of a presidential term (p21).

FROM THE DESK

"Creditors have better memories than debtors."

Benjamin Franklin, *Poor Richard's Almanack*, **1758**[1]

Franklin meant money. He could have meant a prospectus that names a sum due in 2045 (p7), or a cloth that remembers every patch (p15).

THE STRIP · AT MONDAY'S CLOSE

US 10-year[2]	4.91%	▼ 3bp
US 10-year real[2]	2.62%	▲ 2bp
10-yr breakeven	2.29%	desk's own
Brent[3]	$103.96	▼ 8.4%
Gold spot	$3,941	▲ 1.7%
Bitcoin	$76,758	▼ 1.3%
VWRA	$189.70	▲ 0.62%
USD/SGD	1.2793	▼ 0.13%
Straits Times	5,303.83	▼ 1.36%

Oil fell nine dollars and the real cost of money rose (p14). Gold and bitcoin are evening daily-series levels, not exchange closes. Not advice.[2]

FROM THE ARCHIVE · NO. 107, AND THE NUMBER THAT ENDED THE TRIM LOOP

A Tuesday evergreen, since the Index runs Fridays and the Scoreboard Saturdays. Forty-five issues ago this desk stopped guessing how much copy fits on a page and measured it.[4]

The method was to render an issue as a control and read the page back out of the browser. An interior page's two columns hold about **3,200 to 3,400 characters** of visible text — roughly seventeen characters per millimetre of column height.

The issue that followed ignored it. No. 108 was drafted at 178,600 characters against the control's 139,200, and came out of its first render with **all twenty-six interior pages overset, the worst by 287 millimetres**.

The lesson was not about typography. A page is a container with a known capacity, and writing to it is cheaper than cutting to it — which is also, more or less, the argument of this issue.

It is also a rule with a measurable second half. The blocks do not break: a chatter box, a stat and a vote box are unbreakable units, so cutting words from the shorter of the two columns moves the page height not at all. The thing to shorten is whichever block sets the taller column.

Hence the order of cuts this book now uses — sources first, at roughly forty-three characters to the millimetre; then a whole brief strip or a viewpoint panel; and prose last, because prose is rarely what made the page too long.

SOURCES 1 Benjamin Franklin, *Poor Richard's Almanack*; the maxim appears in the 1758 preface later printed as "The Way to Wealth". 2 Levels at Monday 2 November's close, each sourced instrument by instrument on p14, where the United States Treasury's own daily par and real yield curves supply both yield lines and this desk's arithmetic supplies the breakeven. **Gold and bitcoin are evening daily-series levels, not exchange closes; the London bullion benchmark's own price file is licence-gated and refused this desk, and the Monetary Authority's exchange-rate page carried no rates.** 3 A last price at 16:01 New York time, not an exchange settlement. 4 This magazine's own Issue Log and brand specification, Nos. 107 and 108.

THE WORLD · HORMUZ

Araghchi offers to reopen Hormuz in two days; Washington has not accepted

Oil fell anyway. Brent lost $9.49 on Monday, 8.4 per cent, to $103.96 — and the Hormuz strait stayed shut to everyone.

Iran's foreign minister, Abbas Araghchi, said in Ashgabat on **Sunday 1 November** that Qatari and Pakistani mediation had compressed his government's plan for reopening the Strait of Hormuz to two days: on day one Washington delivers a package of six measures, on day two the shipping lane opens. **Washington has not accepted it.** President Trump, asked about Iran at a rally on Monday, said: "*One way or the other, we will do something, but there is no rush.*"[1]

The strait is the sea gate between the Gulf and the open ocean, and roughly a fifth of the world's traded oil leaves through it. Shut to unauthorised traffic since the summer, it is why the price of crude has spent four months answering to a diplomatic calendar rather than to a drilling rig. On Monday the calendar moved and the cargo did not: **Brent fell 8.4 per cent in a session**, the largest one-day fall of the war, on a plan one of the two governments has not signed.[2]

Araghchi's conditions are not about shipping: American recognition of one sanctioned route through Iran and Oman with all others closed, sanctions lifted, a smaller American military presence, the June oil waivers restored, frozen Iranian funds released. He listed six. Mohsen Rezaei, secretary of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, told state media the same week that there were seven — and that he had read a letter from Vice-President JD Vance without replying, calling the change of tone "*a good sign*" while warning of "*devastating blows*" if Washington errs.[3]

Nor does the timetable agree with itself. Tehran is selling two days; the paper circulating in Doha runs to **three days of confidence-building measures** before direct talks begin.[4]

Meanwhile the thing the plan would end carried on. The Qatari gas carrier **Al Mayeda**, struck on the night of Friday 30 October, came off lightly: its owner, Qatar Gas Transport Company, says "*none of the crew members was injured*" — twenty-five aboard, six Indian nationals — and the ship is operational. Saudi Arabia condemned the attack on Sunday. Nobody has said who fired.[5]

THE CHATTER · WHAT TRADERS MADE OF ARAGHCHI'S TWO DAYS

The desks read the two-day plan as a position, not a delivery. **Eamonn Sheridan** of investingLive, within hours of Araghchi: it "*offers a theoretical path to restored flows, but its conditions reach well beyond shipping*", and traders would take it "*as a negotiating position rather than a near-term supply fix*". **Michael Ball**, macro strategist on Bloomberg's markets desk, after Monday's fall: "*The oil selloff reinforces the distinction traders now need to make: physical tightness remains real.*" **Jemima Shelley** of United Against Nuclear Iran counts nine small tankers through the blockade since July: "*Most vessels aren't.*"[6]

THE SCEPTIC · WHY HORMUZ WILL NOT OPEN IN TWO DAYS

BMI, Fitch's research arm, puts a Hormuz deal in **early 2027** and forecasts Brent averaging **$107 this quarter and $112 in the first quarter of 2027** before falling to **$67** by the end of it — a sequence with no room for a reopening this week. The physical market agrees: war-risk cover for a Hormuz transit has gone from about **0.25 per cent of hull value before the war to between 3 and 10 per cent**, and owners will not send a laden ship through uncleared mines on a verbal timetable. **Dated falsifier:** an American acceptance of the Iran–Oman route, a dated sanctions action, and premia under one per cent.[7]

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SHIPPING INCIDENTS LOGGED BY THE BRITISH MARITIME MONITOR SINCE THE WAR BEGAN; MONDAY'S WAS A VESSEL HOLED OFF OMAN[5]

SOURCES 1 Araghchi to Al Jazeera and the Iranian state agency, 1 November 2026, via Middle East Eye's live file and Al Jazeera, 2 November; Trump from the Fox News live file, 2 November. 2 Brent's session move read on the exchange series at 16:01 New York time — **a last price, not an ICE settlement, which this desk could not obtain.** West Texas Intermediate fell 7.7 per cent to about $96. 3 Al Jazeera, 2 November, for the six conditions; Rezaei's seven via Xinhua, 1 November. **Two arms of one government publish two counts and this desk cannot reconcile them.** 4 Axios's account of the Qatari paper, in the Fox live file. 5 Qatar Gas Transport Company and the Saudi foreign ministry, both via Arab News, 1 November; the incident count from the CBS News live file, 30 October. 6 investingLive, 1 November; Bloomberg via SwissInfo, 2 November; United Against Nuclear Iran via Fox. 7 BMI and JPMorgan via Yahoo Finance, 28 October; JPMorgan's model fair value for Brent is **$94**.

THE WORLD · BEIJING AND THE GULF

Xi signs fourteen agreements with Oman as Beijing moves into the Iran file

Wang Yi told Iran's deputy foreign minister on 2 November that dialogue is "the only viable path forward". A Fudan dean says Tuesday's American midterms will decide the rest.

Xi Jinping and Sultan Haitham bin Tariq of Oman signed **fourteen cooperation documents** in Beijing on **Monday 2 November**, Xi calling the relationship a "*new historical starting point*". The same day, foreign minister **Wang Yi** received Iran's deputy foreign minister, Ali Bagheri Kani, and told him dialogue was "*the only viable path forward*".[1]

Oman matters for one reason: it sits at the other end of the single shipping route Tehran wants recognised (p3). A government that has spent the war as the quiet venue for messages between Washington and Tehran has now signed a sheaf of agreements with the great power that buys most of Iran's oil.[1]

What the capitals say about the same week diverges more sharply than the facts do, and the panels below set three of those framings side by side. The common thread is the date: **3 November**, when Americans vote in their midterm elections. **Wu Xinbo**, dean of the Institute of International Studies at Fudan University, in Beijing's state press: "*Midterm elections typically center on domestic issues, yet this one is different*" — its result "*is likely to exert a marked impact on US foreign policy and international dynamics, with repercussions concentrated in the Middle East.*"[2]

He is not alone. Reporting in Israel has Netanyahu urging strikes on Iran immediately after the vote; Secretary of State Rubio said on Sunday that Trump "*hasn't made a decision*" but "*we would prefer to do it peacefully*".[3]

DOHA — AL JAZEERA **2 NOV**

Spokesman **Esmaeil Baghaei**, framing the offer as conditional: "*If Iran's demands are met, it is possible that both security will be restored to the Strait of Hormuz.*"[4]

BEIJING — GLOBAL TIMES **2 NOV**

Xi Jinping on the Gulf: it "*should not become an arena for great-power rivalry and geopolitical conflict*" — in the week China signed fourteen agreements with a Gulf state.[1]

JERUSALEM — THE TIMES OF ISRAEL **2 NOV**

Trump on the unfinished target list: "*We still have to take care of, I would say, one or two sites, but we can do that in 10 minutes*" — while calling talks "*going fine*".[3]

THE CHATTER · HOW BEIJING'S ENTRY IS BEING READ

Katrina Yu, reporting from Beijing for Al Jazeera, on why the Oman signing and the Bagheri Kani meeting fell in the same twenty-four hours: "*I think China is very frustrated, and it wants to be seen to enter [the process].*" Beijing is not mediating so much as registering an interest: it has no seat in Doha and no leverage over the American package, but it buys the oil that cannot leave.[5]

THE SCEPTIC · FOURTEEN DOCUMENTS IS NOT A POLICY

Against reading Beijing's week as a turn: China has signed cooperation documents with Gulf states for a decade, and neither remark commits it to anything. Nobody has published what the fourteen documents cover. No Chinese official has offered to guarantee a transit, insure a hull or sweep a mine — the three things a reopening needs (p3). **Dated falsifier:** a named Chinese role in Doha, or a naval escort through the strait.[6]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Russia bombs a shelter in Zaporizhzhia. Bombs hit an aid centre at **Komyshuvakha** on **2 November**, killing **26** with about **20** missing; drones kept attacking the site, hampering rescue. Zelenskyy: "*This is further proof that Russia wants no de-escalation.*"[7]

Someone is cooking Europe's supermarket fridges. Attacks on **2 November** pushed cooling units to **50°C** across six countries — **Carrefour** 15 of its 700-plus Belgian shops, **Coop Sweden** six, **Musgrave** 13 Irish stores dumping chilled stock. Last month's French version caused fires. **No claim of responsibility.**[8]

Bulgaria elects its first female president. Iliana Yotova, **57.6 per cent** to Andrey Gyurov's 39.5, on 1 November.[9]

SOURCES 1 Chinese readouts of the Oman signing and the Wang–Bagheri Kani meeting via Al Jazeera, 2 November 2026. 2 Wu Xinbo in Global Times, 2 November. 3 The Times of Israel, 2 November; Rubio via CBS News, 1 November. 4 Al Jazeera, 2 November. 5 The same. 6 This desk; **the fourteen documents' contents are published by neither government.** 7 NBC News, 2 November — **its web address says 24 dead where its headline and body say 26; the body figure is printed.** 8 NBC News. 9 Associated Press via NBC News.

SINGAPORE · THE CHANGI WORK PASSES

Manpower ministry investigates about forty-five firms over Changi work passes

About 270 workers employed by SATS contractors may have been wrongly deployed, the ministry said on 2 November; it has told SATS to tighten oversight beneath it.

The Ministry of Manpower said on **Monday 2 November** that it is investigating **about forty-five companies** involved in airport operations at Changi for suspected offences under the Employment of Foreign Manpower Act, after an inspection found holders of Singapore's highest-tier work pass handling baggage. Its own words: "*Preliminary investigations suggest that the salaries and occupations declared to MOM for these EP holders were false.*"[1]

The Employment Pass is the permit Singapore issues to foreign professionals, and it carries the highest salary floor of any pass the country grants. That is what makes the finding unusual: the allegation is not that cheap labour came in on the wrong permit, but that the expensive permit was the cover. About **270 workers**, employed by **SATS**' contractors and sub-contractors, "*may not have been deployed in compliance with work pass regulations*".[1]

The ministry has not acted against the listed company at the top of the chain. It has **directed SATS** to strengthen oversight of its contractors and issued an advisory to other firms — an instrument of compliance, not of enforcement. What enforcement would look like is published: a false declaration carries a fine of up to **S$20,000**, up to **two years** in jail, or both; illegal deployment carries a penalty of up to **S$10,000** and a possible hiring bar. Nobody has been charged, and the ministry says it will act "*if breaches of the EFMA are established*". SATS did not reply to a request for comment.[2]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE CHANGI CHAIN ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

No forum thread on the Changi probe existed by Monday night, and this desk will not invent one: **Reddit refused us for the nineteenth issue running and HardwareZone's search returns 403.** What is on the record is the market the forty-five firms sit in: ground handling at Changi is low-margin work staffed through layers of sub-contract, in a labour market that has just tightened. A shortcut needs no conspiracy when the queue is that long.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · FORTY-FIVE IS A COUNT OF INVESTIGATIONS

The number in the headline is not a finding. Forty-five companies are being investigated; the ministry names none, has charged none, and says enforcement follows only "*if*" breaches are established. The instrument used on SATS is a **direction to strengthen oversight**; the only measurable outcome so far is an advisory. **Dated falsifier:** a charge sheet, a named firm, or a hiring bar.[4]

270

WORKERS OF SATS CONTRACTORS WHO THE MINISTRY SAYS MAY HAVE BEEN DEPLOYED OUTSIDE THEIR PASS CONDITIONS[1]

ALSO ON THE DESK · THE HAZE FILE REACHES THE FLOOR

The power to compel arrives today. All ten companies served notices met ministers on **28 October** — Shanmugam: "*they all came*", and "*the payment for the assessors will be made by the companies*". He said Grace Fu would move legislation under which "*failure to cooperate with the assessors will itself be made into an offence*". That sitting is **today** — after the consent was given, not before.[5]

The panel is seven, and the companies pay for it. Named **30 October**: **Control Risks**, **FTI Consulting** and **Kroll** to investigate; **Dentons Rodyk**, **TSMP**, **WongPartnership** and **Toby Landau KC** on the law. More than **50 haze questions from over 30** members are down for today, and Sylvia Lim asks why the 2015 cases are unresolved after eleven years: of six, **two closed, four open, no fine ever levied.**[6]

SOURCES 1 Ministry of Manpower release, 2 November 2026, read in full; quotations as carried by Bernama and AsiaOne. 2 The same release; AsiaOne for the approach to SATS — **sats.com.sg returned a firewall challenge, so no company statement is quoted.** 3 Labour-market advance release, 30 October. 4 Ministry of Manpower, 29 October, on the dormitories charge. 5 Doorstop transcript of 28 October, read in full. 6 Ministry of Law and the environment agency, 30 October; MustShareNews, 2 November — **Parliament's own order paper returned an empty document.**

THE ATELIER · AXES & HATCHETS

The twenty-year guarantee on a Gränsfors axe excludes its handle

A replacement handle is CAD $45 to $60 against CAD $230 for the axe; the part that fails is the wood.

Gränsfors Bruk of Hälsingland, Sweden publishes the most candid warranty in the tool trade, and its most useful sentence is an exclusion: "*The axe-handle is not covered by the extended 20 year warranty.*" Twenty years on the steel; nothing on the wood — an accurate description of how an axe wears out.[1]

An axe is two objects pretending to be one. The head is a forged lump that outlives its owner; the handle is shaped hickory with a service life in years. The whole buy-once case turns on whether you can replace it — settled at purchase, by whether the head was hung on a wooden wedge or moulded around a plastic shaft. One is repairable; the other is not.[1]

The good makers publish their steel and the famous ones do not. Gränsfors hardens **only the edge — 820°C, quenched in water**, tempered at **195°C for sixty minutes** — leaving the head's body soft so the eye absorbs shock. Council Tool publishes **Rockwell 48 to 55**; Helko Werk **53 to 56**. A pocket knife runs 58 to 62. An axe is deliberately softer: a hard bit chips on a knot, and a chipped bit cannot be filed straight.[2]

On the handle, the variable that predicts failure is grain direction, not species. **House Handle** of Missouri sells it as a priced option: grain "*parallel to your axe blade*" with minimal run-out, for **two dollars**, and no lacquer for **fifty cents** — worth paying, since a varnished handle cannot be fed oil.[3]

THE CHATTER · WHAT OWNERS SAY THE SWEDISH AXE BUYS

The forums have argued Gränsfors against Fiskars for fifteen years and converged somewhere uncomfortable. **Mark Bolam**, on Arbtalk, 17 August 2018: "*I don't think you'll notice much difference in performance. They are both excellent.*" **ThrustSSC** had not sharpened his through roughly **a hundred tons** of hardwood. **Bladeforums and Reddit refused us.**[4]

THE SCEPTIC · WHAT GRÄNSFORS PUBLISHES AND OTHERS DO NOT

Gränsfors prints its press tonnage, its quench temperature and its steel designation. The tell is not the age of the mark; it is whether the maker puts a number beside it. Ochsenkopf carries a Remscheid trademark from **2 June 1781** and **publishes no steel grade or hardness at all**; it is now a line in the GEDORE group. **Hults Bruk**, founded **1697**, publishes neither, and its production page reads "*Coming soon*". And the markup has receipts: **Best Made's Optimist is $450** for an American 5160 Hudson Bay — forged, its own page says, by **Nathan Brandt at Farm Smith, Indiana** — against **Council's Velvicut at $154.25: 2.9×** for the same steel and pattern.[5]

1,880

HICKORY'S JANKA HARDNESS AGAINST ASH'S 1,320; THE RETURNS STOP NEAR US$150[3]

THE TIERS, AND THE SINGAPORE REALITY

The sweet spot. Gränsfors Small Forest Axe **£145**; Council Velvicut American Felling **$207.95**, with a **lifetime** guarantee on the head.[6]

And a Singapore flat has no woodpile. The honest purchase is the carpenter's axe: Mizuno's ko-ono **$118**, Gränsfors' Carpenters Axe **£122**. One axe per parcel under **S$400** clears without duty. **No Singapore stockist could be verified.** Hickory swells **10.5 per cent** tangentially green to oven-dry, so read "check the hang regularly" as monthly.[7]

NEXT ON THE BENCH · VOTE FOR TOMORROW'S CATEGORY

Hand saws — tooth geometry, set and the pull stroke.

Secateurs & loppers — bypass against anvil; who sells spare blades.

Oil lamps & lanterns — wick, draught and glass.

SOURCES 1 Gränsfors Bruk's guarantee page, read in full; handle prices from Canadian Outdoor Equipment. 2 Gränsfors' materials and production pages; Council Tool's page and FAQ; Helko Werk. **Council's Velvicut page gives Rockwell 50–54 in its specifications and 52–56 in its description.** 3 The Wood Database; House Handle. 4 Arbtalk, 2018 and 2014; Hearth.com, 2013. 5 GEDORE's Ochsenkopf page; Hults Bruk; Stubai; Best Made; Council Tool. 6 knivesandtools; Council Tool; Bernal Cutlery. 7 Singapore Customs and the Inland Revenue Authority; Gränsfors' care pages. **Whether a bladed hand tool is a controlled import could not be resolved.**

TECHNOLOGY · ANTHROPIC'S AMENDMENT

Amended filing puts Anthropic's compute commitment at $895.4 billion to 2045

Monday's amendment filled a blank the 26 October original left empty. Nine-month revenue was $33.2 billion; the box marked "Run-Rate Revenue as of October 31" is still empty.

Anthropic lodged an amended registration statement with the American share regulator on **Monday 2 November**, and in doing so answered the question its first filing left open seven days earlier. The company has promised suppliers **$895.4 billion**, "*substantially all of which is related to compute and infrastructure*", stretching to **2045**. Against that, revenue in the nine months to September was **$33.2 billion**: for every dollar earned, about twenty-seven promised.[1]

A registration statement is the booklet a company must lodge before it may sell shares to the public, filed in stages with blanks filled as the sale nears. This desk downloaded both documents and compared them. The original printed the commitment four times as a dollar sign followed by nothing; the amendment replaces every one with a figure, rolls the accounts forward a quarter, and leaves the price of a share — "*between $ and $*".[1]

The schedule inside the number is the part to read. Of the total, **$447.5 billion** falls before the end of 2030 and substantially all the rest between **2031 and 2045**; **$69.8 billion** is due within twelve months, and a further **$150 to $175 billion** is excluded because the amounts are "*not yet determinable*". Named: **Amazon**, at least **$110 billion** to April 2036 "*regardless of actual usage*". Third-quarter revenue was **$17.0 billion** against $1.4 billion a year before — yet the quarterly table shows an operating **profit of $974 million in the second quarter and a loss of $567 million in the third**. The nine-month net loss is **$104.0 billion**, of which **$94.3 billion** is the revaluation of its own convertible notes and future-equity agreements: a loss manufactured by its own rising price.[2]

THE CHATTER · WHAT READERS OF ANTHROPIC'S FILING SAID

The amendment reached the front page of Hacker News within hours — **218 points, 237 comments**, where the original drew **1,709** points on 26 October. **cmiles8**: "*The issue is this is a probably $200-300B company pretending it's a $2T company*", and on the accounting, "*It's also just wrong to keep dismissing the paper losses from convertible notes as somehow not real losses.*" **coldtea**: "*Most of it is a pre-IPO hype and a circular financing loop between Nvidia, Oracle, Amazon, and the AI players.*"[3]

THE SCEPTIC · WHAT ANTHROPIC IS ACTUALLY WORTH

David Trainer, founder of the research house New Constructs, called the offering "*the most ridiculous IPO of 2026*" on 6 October and said plainly: "*We don't think Anthropic has a viable business.*" His firm values it at **$150 billion** against a reported ambition near **$2 trillion**, and argues it would need **double Nvidia's trailing four-quarter net income**, which "*topped $190 billion*". The sharpest dissent is inside the document: sequential revenue growth decelerating to about **47 per cent** from roughly 144, an operating line back in deficit, and a commitment schedule running nineteen years past it. **Dated falsifier:** the price range and the 31 October run-rate figure, whenever they are filed.[4]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Setting the record straight. No. 151 reported that Anthropic's 26 October statement left its compute commitment blank "while naming US$637 billion". This desk has since downloaded that document and searched it: the blanks are there, but **no figure of $637 billion appears anywhere in it**. The original named no commitment total at all. The error was ours.[5]

Microsoft's ten coupons landed; Meta's raise was equity. The final pricing supplement, filed **07:00 on 2 November**, fills every blank No. 151 printed: **4.850 per cent** to 2028 out to **6.350 per cent to 2066**, settling **4 November**. And of Meta's **$37.5bn**, **$25bn** was 40 million shares at **$625.00** through a forward sale, with a free writing prospectus naming **Nvidia, AMD and Broadcom** as "*Cornerstone Investors*" for up to **$5.0 billion**; Nvidia's newsroom confirms **$3 billion**. Two of Meta's three biggest chip suppliers are buying shares in their customer.[6]

SOURCES 1 Anthropic's Amendment No. 1 to its Form S-1, registration 333-299633, filed 2 November 2026, and the original of 26 October — **both downloaded in full from the Securities and Exchange Commission's system by this desk and compared line by line.** 2 The same amendment's liquidity, obligations and quarterly tables. 3 Hacker News items 50337439 and 50242939. 4 New Constructs via CNBC, 7 October; the growth arithmetic is CNBC's, from a filing that prints no quarterly revenue row. 5 This desk's correction, searched on the downloaded document. 6 Microsoft's 424B2 of 2 November; Meta's 424B5s of 28 October and its free writing prospectus; Nvidia's newsroom.

THE HOME LAB · VULKAN TENSOR PARALLEL

Gerganov merges a Vulkan tensor-parallel patch into llama.cpp after 129 days

Eight owners measured it on their own machines: a pair of 2016 cards went from 33.8 to 47.3 words a second. The GitHub issue asking for it was auto-closed as inactive the day before.

To run one of the large open artificial-intelligence assistants on your own machines rather than renting someone else's, you generally need several graphics cards, because no single one holds enough fast memory. On **Monday 2 November**, **Georgi Gerganov** merged a change into the free software most enthusiasts use for this, and it lets every card work on the very same word at once — where until now they took turns, each holding a slice of the model and idling while the others worked.[1]

What makes it matter is not the speed but the door it opens. The fast version of this trick has until now been the property of one chipmaker's private software. This one runs on the open graphics standard every manufacturer supports, which means it works on cards from any of them — including old ones. Eight separate owners posted before-and-after measurements from their own machines within days, and one pair of cards launched in **2016**, now worth a few tens of dollars each, went from **33.8 to 47.3 words a second**: forty per cent faster, same hardware, same model, on the day the change landed.[2]

The patch is pull request **25051** in the llama.cpp repository, by the contributor **pwilkin**, opened **26 June** and approved by the project's Vulkan maintainer **0cc4m** on **30 October** — **129 days** from proposal to merge. It rewrites the pooling step in which every card hands round its partial answer — the expensive part of working in parallel, and the reason this was hard. The reproductions are unusually good: **0cc4m**, on two AMD R9700s, took a 27-billion-parameter model from **27.0 to 45.0** tokens a second; **cattivik66**, on two Radeon Pro W7800s, measured **25 per cent** more prompt throughput and **49 per cent** more generation. The same day Gerganov merged a companion Intel patch, **30956**, worth **19.9 per cent** on prefill.[3]

THE CHATTER · WHERE THE VULKAN PATCH BREAKS ON REAL MACHINES

The thread is also where the feature's limits were found, by the people running it. **digitalscream** reported a first request at about 36 tokens a second and a follow-up turn that "*dropped to about 2 t/s*"; **AbdullahMPrograms** reproduced that collapse at **3.37**. **wizardeur** could not reproduce it at all. On the Intel patch, **AdamN1** on three Arc Pro B70s: "*I don't have any performance increase*"; the author replied that the pooling code supports only two cards. **Reddit is unreachable, so r/LocalLLaMA does not appear.**[4]

THE SCEPTIC · THE ONE MACHINE WHERE VULKAN LOST TO LAYER SPLIT

AbdullahMPrograms posted the only full set of numbers in which the feature is a net loss, on Radeon Pro W7900s. Plain layer splitting generated at **33.94** tokens a second; the patch on two cards managed **29.77 — 12 per cent slower** — falling to 23.23 on five. The vendor's proprietary path on those same five did **48.57**, and **2,033** against 342 on prefill. Add **cattivik66**'s finding that on an 88,000-token prompt tensor decode fell to **9** tokens a second against 37, and the honest reading is a two-card feature that scales badly, regresses at long context, and loses where the proprietary toolchain exists.[5]

129

DAYS THE PATCH SAT OPEN. ITS TRACKING ISSUE WAS AUTO-CLOSED AS INACTIVE BY A BOT ON 1 NOVEMBER, REOPENED THE SAME DAY, AND IS STILL OPEN[6]

STILL ON THE BENCH

A wrong-answer bug, a verified fix, and 126 days of silence. vLLM issue **55766**, opened **7 September**, reports not-a-number logits in hybrid models after a prefix-cache hit, after which affected requests emit token zero until they stop. **JulianZJN** traced it on four RTX 4090s and reported the count "*dropped to zero*" with pull request **47123** applied. That patch, opened **30 June**, is **unmerged on its 126th day**, still awaiting a first review, and has missed two releases including **v0.33.0**, which shipped on 2 November. Separately, Mistral added a technical report to its Mistral Large 4 card on 2 November — which still states no weight size: the two main four-bit builds sit **30 gigabytes apart**, at **605** and **635GB**. **And llama.cpp v1.0.0 has not shipped.**[7]

SOURCES 1 llama.cpp pull request 25051, read at source 2 November 2026. 2 netrunnereve's reproduction tables in that thread, on two AMD RX 470 cards. 3 The same thread and pull request 30956. 4 The same two threads. **Handles are repository pseudonyms; 0cc4m and arthw are the maintainers, the rest self-reported, several with large error bars.** 5 The same thread. 6 llama.cpp issue 22648, closed as not planned and reopened 1 November. 7 vLLM issue 55766, pull request 47123 and the v0.33.0 notes; the Mistral Large 4 card and its commits; llama.cpp's tags.

THE KIT · THE AURA

XREAL opens Aura orders at $1,099 and publishes no battery life

Google calls it the first wired glasses running its headset system: 95 grams on the face, a 265-gram puck in the pocket, shipping mid-November. No Singapore price exists.

XREAL and **Google** opened orders on **Wednesday 28 October** for the Aura, a pair of display glasses that puts its computer in a separate pocket unit on the end of a cable, at **$1,099** for the 12-gigabyte version and **$1,299** for the 16 — launch prices struck through from $1,279 and $1,499, and running, the maker says, "*through the end of the year*". Orders opened in America, Canada and Korea, Japan followed on 2 November, and shipping begins mid-November.[1]

The idea is a screen that floats in front of you without a phone or a laptop behind it. What is unusual is the cable: the glasses weigh **95 grams** and do the seeing, while a **265-gram** puck in your pocket holds the processor and the whole battery. The maker publishes a great deal about that puck — **34.84 watt-hours**, 48 trillion operations a second — and about the lenses: **1920 by 1200** per eye, up to **120 hertz**, **1,050 nits**, a **70-degree** field of view. What it does not publish anywhere is **how long any of it runs**, the glasses' own battery capacity, or whether the puck is in the box.[2]

Two things follow. The only runtime figure in existence comes from a journalist wearing pre-production hardware: Android Authority's **Adamya Sharma**, on 6 September, put it at "*about four to five hours for streaming*" and noted the company "*didn't provide every battery detail*". And there is no Singapore price: the maker's Singapore page returns a 404, and its store lists every market outside America, Canada, Japan and Korea as "*still to be confirmed*".[3]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE AURA'S PRICE AND PUCK PROVOKED

The Hacker News thread ran to **108 points and 110 comments**, almost all of it about the two numbers. **classictraffic**: "*$1099 is so nuts*". **starkparker**, with the counterfactual: "*if the Aura was available at $700-$800 puckless they'd be a genuine upgrade*". And **zmmmmm**, on the category: "*the real choice is the unfortunate one of who is least likely to abandon the whole thing*".[4]

THE SCEPTIC · SEVENTY DEGREES IS THE AURA'S BARE MINIMUM

Ben Lang of Road to VR, who has worn one, is the most useful dissent because he agrees with the specification and not with the claim. The **70-degree** field "*felt usable*", he writes — and "*seems like the bare minimum field-of-view needed to get real value out of an immersive operating system*". On the dimming: at full strength "*you'll still see lots of the real-world in your peripheral vision*", while at zero "*the real world is still made fairly dim; like wearing sunglasses inside*" — enough that he "*wouldn't want to use them in the kitchen*". He reports pupil swim, "*dizzying over time*" for some, and no eye tracking. **No independent measurement of shipping hardware exists.**[5]

265g

WEIGHT OF THE POCKET UNIT THAT HOLDS THE AURA'S PROCESSOR AND ITS ENTIRE BATTERY, AGAINST 95 GRAMS ON THE FACE[2]

ALSO ON THE SHELF

Two laptops running Google's desktop system, two mediocre verdicts. Engadget gave the **Lenovo Googlebook 15** (**$1,099**, 15.3-inch 120-hertz screen, 8.5 hours of video) **7.9** on 30 October, knocking app compatibility; it gave the **Dell XPS Googlebook** (about **$999**, 2.2lb, no headphone jack, 15 hours 15 minutes on test) **6.5** on 2 November, with the verdict "*Googlebook OS is half-baked*" and "*Using mobile Android apps stinks*".[6]

And a head-worn tracker with one accuracy figure, published by its maker. Temple opened pre-orders on **1 November** at about **US$1,000**, made to order; the only accuracy number anywhere is its own, **1.18 beats per minute** average deviation across **43** participants, on a treadmill. **Nobody independent has evaluated it.**[7]

SOURCES 1 XREAL's own Aura page and US store, read 2 November 2026; Google's post by Shahram Izadi, 28 October. 2 The maker's specification table, read in full — **no runtime, no glasses-battery capacity, no statement that the puck ships in the box.** 3 Android Authority, 6 September; the Singapore page returns 404. **TechCrunch printed the field of view as 95 degrees against the 70 on the maker's and Google's own pages.** 4 Hacker News item 50282538. 5 Road to VR, Ben Lang's hands-on. 6 Engadget, 30 October and 2 November. 7 Notebookcheck, 2 November.

THE GOOD LIFE · SINN'S ANNIVERSARY

Sinn re-makes its Spacelab chronograph, 300 pieces at €5,490

Reinhard Furrer bought his own 140 S before the 1985 mission. Frankfurt's 65th-anniversary version is 44mm, and its power reserve is published as both 42 and 46 hours.

Sinn Spezialuhren of Frankfurt announced on **Tuesday 27 October** a 65th-anniversary re-make of the automatic chronograph that went into orbit in 1985, reference **140.050**, limited to **300 pieces** at **€5,490** in Europe and **$6,980** in America. The original has a claim few watches can make: in October 1985 the German physicist **Reinhard Furrer** wore a Sinn 140 S aboard the Spacelab mission, a watch he had bought himself shortly before launch.[1]

That flight settled an argument. A self-winding mechanical watch is wound by a weighted rotor swinging on the wrist, and the trade had assumed that in weightlessness it would have nothing to swing against and the watch would stop. It did not. Furrer's chronograph kept running, which is why a mid-sized German firm owns a genuine piece of horological history — and why, forty-one years on, it is selling three hundred copies of the thing that proved it.[1]

The watch is unapologetically large: **44mm** across, **15.5mm** deep, **118 grams** without a strap, in steel hardened by Sinn's Tegiment process under a black coating, water-resistant to **100 metres** and, the maker says, working down to **−45°C**. The movement is Sinn's SZ01, a central-minute chronograph on the Valjoux 7750 architecture. The price includes both bracelet and strap. One caution: **two outlets publish two different power reserves**, 46 hours and 42; the maker's site refused this desk, so the figure is held.[2]

THE CHATTER · WHAT COLLECTORS SAID ABOUT THE 140 A S

Fifteen comments under Fratello's announcement, and the argument is size against value. **MarkBu**, approving: "*That's what I call a tool watch.*" **Tam O' Banter**: "*Solid, serious and reliable*", a likely lifelong watch. **AmitaS**, at a 17-centimetre wrist, thinks 40mm the practical maximum; **JayBee** counters that the step up is marginal — "*try one on*". And **Chaz_H** supplies the dissent that stings: he prefers the older 142 with its Lemania 5100 and says he bought one in Tokyo, on a bracelet, **under $2,000**. **WatchUSeek and Reddit refused this desk.**[3]

THE SCEPTIC · WHAT THE SPACELAB STORY IS ACTUALLY WORTH

Fratello's own reviewer concedes the watch is "*relatively heavy, especially in its all-steel configuration*", and asks whether the low-pressure resistance is "*truly necessary*?" — answering "*Perhaps not.*" Worn & Wound puts it plainly: 44 by 15.5 millimetres, "*it's not a small watch*". The value case is harder still. **Berlin_Tony**, in the same thread, notes it is cheaper than a comparable Porsche Design limited edition running a modern Lemania 5100 and says he would pay more for that one — to which **Dennis** replies, "*But you won't, right?*" He concedes he is not motivated to buy either. **No Singapore price and no confirmed local allocation out of the 300 exists;** the retailer's own brand page returns 404.[4]

300

PIECES OF THE SINN 140 A S ANNIVERSARY, AT €5,490 INCLUDING BOTH BRACELET AND STRAP; NO SINGAPORE ALLOCATION IS PUBLISHED[1]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Two watches this week carry no price at all. A. Lange & Söhne's Datograph Perpetual in platinum — **50 pieces**, 41mm, marking twenty years of the model — and **Vacheron Constantin**'s Métiers d'Art Year of the Goat, **25 in platinum and 25 in pink gold**, are both "price on request". **No. 151's held item stands: there is still no published Lange figure.**[5]

Citizen's export price is 23 per cent below its home price. Six Kei automatic references went on sale outside Japan at **€329** in steel and **€349** two-tone, against **¥68,200 and ¥70,400** at home — 38mm, **60-hour** reserve. The export casebacks read "*Japan Movt*" where the Japanese ones read "*Made in Japan*".[6]

SOURCES 1 Swiss Watches Magazine, 27 October 2026, and Fratello the same day, both read at source; Worn & Wound for the dollar price; the authorised dealer Classic-Watch for the reference and the €5,490 figure. **sinn.de returned 403, so nothing here is from the maker's own site.** 2 The same four. **Fratello publishes a 46-hour reserve and Gear Patrol 42; one calls the movement in-house, the other Valjoux-based. Both are left unreconciled.** 3 The comment thread under Fratello's article. 4 The same; The Hour Glass's Sinn page returns 404. 5 Caseback Chronicle, 27 October and 2 November. 6 Notebookcheck, 2 November 2026.

SCREEN & SOUND · THE BLACK PARADE

My Chemical Romance reach their first No. 1, twenty years late

The Black Parade took 78,000 units, up 653 per cent, to top the Billboard 200 dated 7 November — the longest wait to a first No. 1 in the chart's history.

My Chemical Romance went to No. 1 on both sides of the Atlantic in the week to **Sunday 1 November** with a record released in **2006**, and it is the first time the band has topped an album chart anywhere. *The Black Parade*, reissued for its twentieth anniversary, took the Official UK Albums Chart dated **30 October to 5 November** — rising from **162** in its **74th** week on chart — and the Billboard 200 dated 7 November, climbing from **139**.[1]

The original peaked at No. 2 in 2006 on **240,000** copies. This time it moved **78,000** equivalent album units, **up 653 per cent** week on week — and the shape of that number is the story. **68,000** were pure album sales, up **2,082 per cent**, of which **42,000 were vinyl**, the band's best vinyl week ever. Streaming contributed about **10,000**. Billboard calls it the longest wait for an album to reach No. 1 in its history, roughly **twenty years**, beating Toby Keith's sixteen.[2]

What produced it was twenty physical variants and a tour. The reissue shipped in pressings including a Bloodline Red edition, a laser-etched hologram and a package cut from the original analogue master, plus six bonus tracks and three new artworks by James Jean. Behind it, the *Long Live The Black Parade* tour closed its American leg with five nights at the Hollywood Bowl and ends this month in Indonesia. From the band's first chart appearance to its first No. 1: **twenty-two years and four months**.[2]

THE CHATTER · WHY THE BLACK PARADE CAME BACK

Paige Owens, author of 500 *Essential Emo Albums*: "*It's hard to go up against that type of a dedicated fan base*", crediting the anniversary shows for the renewed interest. **Jason Pettigrew**, formerly of *Alternative Press*, on the record: its influences were familiar but "*recontextualized with something remarkably contemporary*". **Ben Gibbard** of Death Cab for Cutie, asked whether this is the clearest case of a veteran band finding a new audience decades on, said "*absolutely*" — "*if something is new to you, it is new.*" On a fifth album, **Gerard Way** told a crowd in September that fans "*deserve another record*" but "*I don't know when it'll be.*"[3]

THE SCEPTIC · A NO. 1 ASSEMBLED FROM TWENTY VARIANTS

The mechanical objection is in the figures the desk just printed: **42,000 of 68,000** copies were vinyl, spread across more than twenty physical editions that the chart counts as one title. **Alice Lange**, writing for Martin Cid Magazine, puts the editorial case: a No. 1 built on an anniversary reissue "*answers a question nobody was really asking*", and confirms the band as "*a touring and catalog operation*" organised around a twenty-year-old record — no new album since 2010, and one new song since. The midweek flash supports her: the Official Charts update already shows the album at **No. 31** for 8 November. **Dated falsifier:** a second week in the top ten, or a new album.[4]

42,000

OF THE 68,000 PURE ALBUM SALES THAT TOOK THE BLACK PARADE TO NO. 1, THE BAND'S BEST VINYL WEEK EVER[2]

ALSO ON THE DESK

Two trackers, two margins, one weekend. *You Can See Everything* (A24) held the American box office for a third weekend — but **Box Office Mojo prints $10,600,685** and a **$200,685** margin over second place, where **The Numbers prints $11,445,628** and a **$445,628** margin. One labels its figures estimates; the other labels nothing. The film is a **two-hour-54-minute** documentary in which Elizabeth Holmes appears as herself, at **96 per cent** from 203 critics, on a **$64m** domestic total.[5]

SOURCES 1 The Official Charts Company's albums chart and its page for the title, read at source 2 November 2026 — **it publishes no unit figure for any album, so no British sales number is printed.** 2 Associated Press syndication and Martin Cid Magazine, both 2 November, citing Luminate and Billboard. **billboard.com, variety.com and rollingstone.com returned payment-required errors, so every Billboard figure is second-hand.** 3 The Associated Press article. 4 Martin Cid Magazine; the Official Charts update page. 5 Box Office Mojo's 2026W44 page and The Numbers' chart; Rotten Tomatoes.

THE FAMILY DESK · THE PERIOD DIARY

O'Brien and Bonny log 506 cycles; period pain in 74 per cent

Published on 30 October in the Journal of Pediatric and Adolescent Gynecology: health, school and activities were each affected in about one cycle in five, and a four-item pain score predicted which.

A study published on **Friday 30 October** in the *Journal of Pediatric and Adolescent Gynecology* did something nobody had done at this age: it asked girls to log every period as it happened, for six months, and then counted what the period cost them. Across **126** post-menarcheal girls aged **10 to 14**, in 17 American states, contributing **506** documented cycles, pain occurred in **375 of them — 74 per cent** — and **113 of the 126 girls, 90 per cent**, had it at least once.[1]

This matters to a parent for a reason that has nothing to do with medicine. Period pain in a twelve-year-old is routinely treated as a thing to be got through, because nobody has measured what it actually displaces. This study did: **health, extracurricular activities and school were each affected in about one cycle in five**. That is not a symptom, it is absence — days of school and training lost on a schedule, to something nobody wrote down. The median age was **13.0**, and **112 of the 126** had been menstruating under three years: the band in which a parent is still working out whether to keep a child home.[1]

The usable finding is a number a parent can take to a doctor. The researchers — Amy Jz, **Sarah O'Brien**, Isaac Kistler and **Andrea Bonny** — scored each cycle on a four-item instrument, and each additional point raised the odds of the period affecting daily life by a factor of **1.64**, with a confidence interval of **1.43 to 1.88**. In other words the severity score is not a mood; it predicts disruption, steeply and consistently. Fatigue, headaches and anxiety came with the pain. **The record carries no funding statement.**[2]

THE CHATTER · WHAT THE PERIOD-PAIN LITERATURE SAYS AROUND IT

The honest summary of the period literature around this study is that prevalence estimates are enormous and unstable, that pain is treated far less often than it is reported, and that a validated severity score of the kind O'Brien and Bonny used is the first instrument a parent and a doctor can compare over time. For register, note what a World Health Organization guideline synopsised on **27 October** does in an adjacent field: it makes behavioural care a **strong** recommendation and says medication and surgery are **not recommended for children** at all. **General guidance, not medical advice.**[3]

THE SCEPTIC · NINETY PER CENT IS NOT A BASE RATE

Do not read 90 per cent as an epidemic. The largest pooled estimate available — de Arruda and colleagues with **Susan Armijo-Olivo**, in *Pain*, across **70 countries** and **336 studies** — puts worldwide prevalence at **71.3 per cent**, confidence interval **68.7 to 73.8**. And its own authors grade their certainty honestly: "*All subgroup analyses showed high heterogeneity* (I^2 = 99.5%–100%) *with very low certainty of evidence.*" A heterogeneity figure at the ceiling means the studies are not measuring the same thing. An app-recruited cohort of 126 girls reporting 90 per cent is a signal to ask the question, not a prophecy; nobody actually knows the base rate.[4]

1 in 5

CYCLES IN WHICH SCHOOL WAS AFFECTED, ACROSS 506 CYCLES LOGGED BY GIRLS AGED TEN TO FOURTEEN OVER SIX MONTHS[1]

STILL ON THE DESK

Trauma-informed parenting gets a consensus, and a rejection. A three-round Delphi study published **27 October** put **166** candidate strategies to **38** clinicians and researchers; **94, or 56.6 per cent**, cleared a **90 per cent** endorsement bar. Endorsed: emotional safety before trauma-focused talk, child-led pacing, validation, parental self-regulation. **Consistently rejected: "resilience-promoting" and prescriptive strategies.** Ages 5 to 18, panel predominantly Australian.[5]

SOURCES 1 Jz, O'Brien, Kistler and Bonny, "A Prospective Study of Life Impact in Five Domains During Menses in a Cohort of Early Adolescents", *Journal of Pediatric and Adolescent Gynecology*, online ahead of print 30 October 2026. 2 The same record, a modified four-item score. 3 Garcia-Casal and Pardo-Hernandez, synopsis of the World Health Organization's obesity guidelines, 27 October, open access; the summary of the period literature is this desk's. 4 de Arruda and colleagues with Armijo-Olivo, *Pain* 167:41–55. 5 King, Melvin, Jorm and Yap, *Child Psychiatry & Human Development*, 27 October 2026.

THE FAMILY DESK · WHERE THE EYES GO

Tracking teenagers' eyes, Bonar and Morningstar find the friend wins

In Developmental Psychology on 29 October: 85 children aged 11 to 15 looked longer at a friend's face than a parent's, at p<.001 — and puberty predicted none of it.

A study published on **Thursday 29 October** in *Developmental Psychology* is unusually hard to argue with, because it did not ask children anything. Its authors, **Bonar** and **Morningstar**, showed **85** children aged **11 to 15** — average age **13.2**, 62 per cent girls — photographs of **their own parent and their own friend**, and tracked where their eyes actually went.[1]

They looked at the friend. By looking time, the bias towards the friend's face over the parent's was significant at **p<.001**. Every parent of a twelve-year-old knows this already; what the study adds is the explanation, and it is not the one everybody reaches for. The bias was **not** associated with pubertal status at all. What it *was* associated with was which of the two the child reported feeling closer to — and that relationship held at **p=.003**.[1]

That inversion is the whole point for a parent of a twelve-year-old. The standard story is that puberty rewires a child towards peers, which makes the shift biological, inevitable and nobody's business. This study says the hormones predict nothing measurable here and the relationship predicts it instead. The lever is not the child's body; it is the quality of the connection — which is the one variable a parent has any purchase on. The study was funded by Canada's Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council. **Its abstract reports coefficients and probabilities but no standardised effect sizes or confidence intervals, so the size of the effect is held rather than printed.**[2]

THE CHATTER · HOW THE ATTENTION FINDING LANDS ON A PARENT

The practical reading of Bonar and Morningstar is a demotion of a familiar excuse. If the shift towards friends were pubertal, a parent could only wait it out; if it tracks closeness, then the thing to work on is the thing one can work on. Note what the study does not say: it does not measure affection, trust or influence, only where a child's eyes go in a laboratory task lasting minutes. And it does not say the friend wins on everything — only that, shown two faces, the friend takes the gaze. **General guidance, not medical advice.**[3]

THE SCEPTIC · BONAR AND MORNINGSTAR'S EIGHTY-FIVE CHILDREN

The case against is the design. **Eighty-five** participants is small for a moderation claim, and the headline comparison is a dot-probe task with eye-tracking — a measure of involuntary attention over seconds, not of a relationship. The closeness measure is self-reported, by children, about their own parents, which is the least reliable rater in the house. And the null on puberty is the finding most likely to be a power problem rather than a fact: with 85 children across a five-year band, an absent association may simply be an undetected one. **Dated falsifier:** a pre-registered replication with a pubertal-staging measure and published effect sizes. The authors publish neither effect sizes nor intervals.[2]

p=.003

STRENGTH OF THE LINK BETWEEN THE GAZE BIAS AND WHICH PERSON THE CHILD FELT CLOSER TO. PUBERTAL STATUS SHOWED NO ASSOCIATION AT ALL[1]

STILL ON THE DESK

The screen-time file stays shut. Three findings this desk covered in the last fortnight — the cross-lagged social-media and depression analysis, the household screen-rules study and the Iceland school-phone evaluation — are all closed as findings, and nothing published since 30 October reopens any of them. The next genuine peg on any of the three is a replication using youth-reported symptoms, or an age-stratified extension below twelve.[4]

SOURCES 1 Bonar and Morningstar, "Adolescent attention to parents and friends: Evidence of social reorientation in early social information processing", *Developmental Psychology*, first published 29 October 2026, read via the indexed record and its grants field. 2 The same record. **The full text is behind a publisher paywall and this desk did not read it; everything here comes from the abstract as indexed.** 3 This desk's reading of source 1. 4 This magazine's own Coverage Ledger, Nos. 149–151.

THE MACRO DESK · THE REAL YIELD

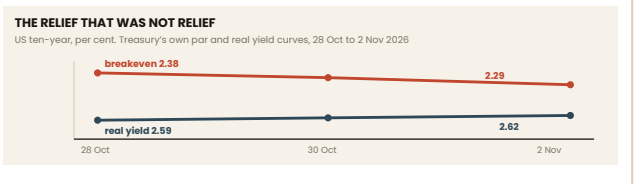
Oil fell 8.4 per cent and Treasury real yields rose

The ten-year inflation breakeven narrowed again, 2.34 to 2.29 per cent, while the ten-year Treasury real yield rose two basis points to 2.62. Oil relief bought no easing at all.

The clearest fact in Monday's market is a subtraction. The **United States ten-year Treasury yield fell three basis points to 4.91 per cent** as crude collapsed on the Hormuz talks (p3) — and the **ten-year inflation-protected yield rose two, to 2.62 per cent**. Both numbers come from the Treasury's own daily curves. Subtract one from the other and the ten-year breakeven, the market's implied average inflation rate, is **2.29 per cent**, down from 2.34 on Friday and 2.38 a week ago.[1]

That arithmetic is the whole regime. A fall in the headline yield looks like relief; here, every basis point of it came out of expected inflation and none out of the real rate. The real rate is what a borrower actually pays after inflation, and at **2.62 per cent** it is the tightest leg of the chain — and it went the wrong way on the day oil fell nine dollars. The front end confirms it: the two-year rose three basis points while the ten and the thirty fell three, flattening the curve from **38 to 32**. That is hike risk being priced, not cuts.[1]

The policymakers are already there. The **Federal Reserve** held at **3.75 to 4.00 per cent** on 28 October by **ten votes to two** — and both dissenters, **Lisa Cook** and **Beth Hammack**, wanted a **quarter-point rise**. St Louis's **Alberto Musalem**: "*I think further tightening of monetary policy is necessary, and action will be needed soon.*" The **Bank of Japan** held at about **1.25 per cent** eight to one, with **Hajime Takata** dissenting for **1.50**, and tripled its exchange-traded-fund disposal to about **¥860bn a year**. The **Bank of Canada** raised rates, its first increase in three years. And the hard data refused to cooperate: the American manufacturing survey printed **55.5** on Monday, production at a five-year high, **prices paid at 75.2**.[2]



A *Meridian* original. The breakeven is the par yield minus the real yield, both from the Treasury's own daily curves; the arithmetic is this desk's.[1]

THE LEVELS · AT MONDAY 2 NOVEMBER'S CLOSE

VWRA[3]	$189.70	▲ 0.62%
US 10-year[1]	4.91%	▼ 3bp
US 10-year real[1]	2.62%	▲ 2bp
10-yr breakeven	2.29%	desk's own
Gold spot[4]	$3,941	▲ 1.7%
Bitcoin[4]	$76,758	▼ 1.3%
Brent[5]	$103.96	▼ 8.4%
Straits Times Index	5,303.83	▼ 1.36%

Gold and bitcoin are evening daily-series levels, not closes; **the bullion benchmark's file is licence-gated.** Not advice.[4]

THE VERDICT · WHAT IT MEANS FOR VWRA, GLOBAL BONDS, GOLD AND BITCOIN

The regime is higher-for-longer, and tight in real terms. For a global all-world equity holding, cheaper oil is a margin tailwind but a **2.62 per cent** real discount rate is a valuation headwind, and Monday showed which dominates: the Dow rose **0.41 per cent** while the Nasdaq Composite fell **1.07**. Global bonds are doing almost nothing: **−0.17 per cent** total return over a year. Gold bounced **1.7 per cent** off a thirteen-month low but sits **29 per cent** below its high — what a rising real yield does to a non-yielding asset. **Explanation, not advice.**[6]

THE SCEPTIC · THE BREAKEVEN AND THE SURVEY CANNOT BOTH BE RIGHT

The disinflation leg of that chain is a market price, not a print. On the day the breakeven said **2.29 per cent**, the manufacturing survey's prices-paid index printed **75.2**; euro-area inflation accelerated to **3.8 per cent** in September. If November's prints follow the breakeven down, the regime flips to easing; if they follow the survey, the Fed hikes — and Cook, Hammack, Takata and Musalem are already voting that way. **Parag Thatte of Deutsche Bank**, meanwhile, is outright long: "*The risk-reward now favors going overweight again*", which is not what one says into a 2.62 real yield.[7]

SOURCES 1 The United States Treasury's own daily par and real yield curves for 2 November 2026 and 30 October; the breakeven and curve arithmetic are this desk's. **The method was checked against the Federal Reserve's published breakeven series for 30 October, which matches at 2.34 exactly.** 2 The Federal Reserve's statement of 28 October and the Bank of Japan's decision document of 30 October, both read in full; Musalem, 31 October; the Institute for Supply Management's October release. 3 Exchange close series, 2 November. 4 Bloomberg via SwissInfo and an independent crypto interface. 5 The exchange series at 16:01 New York time — **a last price, not a settlement.** 6 This desk. 7 Eurostat's September release; Thatte via CNBC.

THE RABBIT HOLE · SASHIKO & BORO

Tokyo protects 786 stitched garments; 324 are Aomori work trousers

Pinterest searches for "sashiko ideas" rose 1,509 per cent this year. The stitching began because Edo-period Tsugaru farmers were forbidden to wear cotton.

On **13 April 1983** Japan designated a collection of **786** stitched garments an Important Tangible Folk Cultural Property. Not swords, not screens: **324 pairs of work trousers**, 175 long robes, 174 short jackets, 76 sleeveless tops and 37 aprons, all from the far north of the main island. They are protected because of what was done to them after they were made — repaired, layered and stitched until the stitching became the object.[1]

The craft is called **sashiko**, literally "little stabs": a running stitch pushed through layered cloth to make it thicker, warmer and stronger, with the reinforcement arranged into a geometric pattern. The patched cloth that results, accumulated across generations, is **boro** — from *boroboro*, tattered. And the thing most Western coverage gets backwards, in the words of the craft's loudest practitioner, is which is which: **Atsushi Futatsuya**, third-generation, writing in *Selvedge*, states flatly that "*the primary essence of Sashiko is not mending*". It is stitched **before** the damage, to postpone it. Boro is the result; sashiko is the habit.[2]

Why anyone was stitching at all is a matter of law, not of thrift. Aomori Prefecture's own cultural-properties pages record that under Tsugaru domain rules in the late Edo period, farmers **were not permitted to wear cotton**. They wore layered hemp, and village women stitched cotton thread into the loose hemp weave at the points that wore first — filling the gaps, adding warmth, and in time turning the reinforcement into design. The Agency for Cultural Affairs dates the shift to cotton cloth with cotton thread to the **Meiji 20s, 1887 to 1896**. The famous white pattern on indigo is contraband cotton, smuggled in stitch by stitch, for warmth.[3]

The craft is now having a moment that has very little to do with Aomori. Pinterest's own trend report, published **25 August 2026**, records searches for "*sashiko ideas*" up **1,509 per cent**, alongside "repair aesthetic" up 167 and "thrift flip ideas" up 610. The communities have grown with it: **r/Visiblemending** stands at **375,000** members, up 56,000 in a year, and the specialist room **r/sashiko** at **60,000**, up **42.4 per cent**. The next two pages descend into what that world costs, what it argues about, and the one tool whose maker has just closed.[4]

THE CHATTER · WHAT CONVERTS PEOPLE TO SASHIKO

The conversion moment is mechanical, and it is the palm thimble. Futatsuya's own account: the round thimble is "*one of the challenging tools to get used to*", worn so the plate sits "*on the palm, not on the finger*", and once the method clicks, "*making as many as* 30 *stitches become possible*" before the thread is pulled through. That — loading a long needle with a whole row and pulling once — is the point at which sashiko stops being embroidery and becomes a rhythm. The sting is in his next line: it is hardest "*especially if you have good amount of experience*" in other needlework. **Reddit is unreachable from this desk, so no beginner's own words appear here;** the subscriber counts come from two independent trackers that agree, each synced 26 October.[5]

THE SCEPTIC · A SEARCH BOOM, NOT A STITCHING BOOM

Read Pinterest's own numbers against each other. "Sashiko ideas" rose **1,509 per cent**; **"darning stitch" — the query of someone about to do the work — rose 91**. Sixteen times more people are looking at this than are learning a stitch. And the money has gone somewhere else entirely: Europe's clothing and footwear repair market was **€2.8bn in 2025**, growing at **5.5 per cent**, and it is a laundry-and-logistics industry — **Patagonia repaired 174,799 items** in its 2025 financial year, Louis Vuitton nearly **600,000**. **No source anywhere publishes a market size for visible mending specifically.** The hand-stitching hobby is a rounding error inside the repair economy it is credited with inspiring.[6]

1,509%

RISE IN PINTEREST SEARCHES FOR "SASHIKO IDEAS", FROM ITS OWN TREND REPORT OF 25 AUGUST 2026. "DARNING STITCH" ROSE 91 PER CENT[4]

SOURCES 1 The Agency for Cultural Affairs' heritage database entry for 「津軽・南部のすしこ着物」, read at source with its itemised breakdown; Aomori Prefecture adds that the garments are held at its Folk Museum, **currently closed for renovation**. 2 Atsushi Futatsuya in *Selvedge*, 1 April 2022. 3 Aomori Prefecture's pages, read in Japanese; the database above. **English tertiary sources state the opposite and are not followed.** 4 Pinterest's Hobbies Trend Report, 25 August 2026. 5 Futatsuya's thimble page; counts from GummySearch and The Hive Index, which agree exactly, synced 26 October. **Both are third-party and rounded.** 6 Circular Fashion News via FashionUnited.

The gear is where this craft stops resembling every other hobby, because the whole functional kit costs under thirty dollars and nothing above fifteen improves your stitching. Begin with the needle, which is the technique. Sashiko needles are **longer and sturdier** than ordinary hand-sewing needles, and the length is the point: it lets multiple stitches be loaded before the thread is pulled through. The eye must be large and smooth so the thread is not abraded; the shaft must not bend when driven with the palm.[1]

The endgame needle is **Tulip of Hiroshima**, a firm founded in **1948** that puts each needle through "*more than 30 manufacturing processes*", packed in a corked glass vial. Its assorted long pack — six needles at **66.7, 51.5 and 44.5 millimetres** — is **$9.75**. Below it, **Clover** at **$4.75** and **Olympus** at **$4.00**; above it, **Cohana** at **$15.00**. **No source this desk read discusses taper or steel hardness, so neither is claimed.**[2]

Thread is where the makers themselves tell you to spend. Sashiko thread is **single-strand and non-divisible** — you never split it, which is the whole difference from embroidery floss — and Olympus's own retailer benchmarks its weight as "*similar to perle cotton #8*". Olympus sells **100-metre** skeins at **$8.35**; Daruma's carded thread is **$3.00**. At the top, **Sashi.Co**'s hand-dyed **145-metre** skeins run **$27.00 to $29.80**. The firm concedes the premium in its own words — its thread is "*relatively more expensive than others*" — and the long-recommended Coron thread **no longer exists**. Futatsuya's own guidance is the most useful sentence in the category: "*you can use ANY KIND of thread for Sashiko stitching*", and "*if budget is limited, spend it on thread*".[3]

The man selling indigo cotton at seventy-eight dollars a yard is the same man who says any cloth will do.

Cloth is the money pit, and the makers admit it. Olympus's blank navy sashiko cotton is **$14.00**; Sashi.Co's hand-dyed indigo cotton is **$78.00 a yard**. The difference buys dye provenance, not stitches. Natural indigo is a real and separate industry — **BUAISOU** of Tokushima grows its own plant and ferments the leaf into *sukumo* — and it is verifiable only when a maker names the dyer or the process. "Indigo" on a thread card usually is not.[4]

Which leaves the thimble — the tool outsiders skip, and the one with a deadline on it. A Japanese sashiko thimble is not a cap for the fingertip but a **ring worn at the base of the middle finger with a flat plate against the palm**. **Clover**'s is **$4.75**, Sashi.Co's from **$12.50**. And on **12 April 2026** Sashiko Story posted that "*the manufacturer of the Sashiko thimbles we have been offering will be closing their business*", and that "*we have not yet found one that is identical*". In a craft where nothing else rewards buying early, this is the one item where buy-once has a date on it.[5]

THE CHATTER · THE FIGHT OVER WHO MAY TEACH SASHIKO

This is the community's running argument, and it has a named centre. **Atsushi Futatsuya** is far more permissive than his reputation: in June 2019 he wrote that you may call your hand-stitching sashiko "*as long as you 'try' to understand and respect the Japanese culture*". Asked in 2024 where appropriation begins, his answer was "*acknowledgement (of the Stories behind)*", the offence being to ignore "*the upstream*" and pretend "*that they 'invented' it*". His complaint is commercial: firms using the word for "*Non-stitched*" products, and projects that "*define what Sashiko/Boro is without even asking/talking to the Japanese people*". **On no page this desk read does he say a non-Japanese person may not teach it.** His test is acknowledgement, not ancestry.[6]

THE SCEPTIC · AUTHENTICITY, MERCHANDISED

The same man now sells **"Consulting Work for Sashiko Project"**, announced **8 July 2024**, precisely because projects define the craft without asking. The complaint is legitimate and the product is real, and his own workshop copy promises "*authenticity, technique, and cultural respect*". Meanwhile his practical advice gives almost everything away free: he recommends **no English-language book at all**, because some "*describe the specific technique as if it explain the whole picture*" — and then published his own in May 2026. The counter-pole is **Susan Briscoe**, trading since **1995**, whose sourcebooks and 52-card deck are exactly the transmissible pattern library he objects to. Both positions are honestly held. Only one is also a price list.[7]

$26.50

THE WHOLE FUNCTIONAL KIT: CLOVER NEEDLES, A METAL PALM THIMBLE, ONE CARDED THREAD AND A BLANK PANEL OF SASHIKO COTTON[8]

SOURCES 1 Colonial Needle, 15 July 2026. 2 Tulip's maker facts via Ministry of Mending; prices at Snuggly Monkey, Loop, Nomura Tailor and Sashiko Story, 2 November 2026. 3 Specifications at Snuggly Monkey and The Workroom; Futatsuya's thread and FAQ pages. **Olympus' and Yokota's own sites were unreachable, so ply, twist and mercerisation are not claimed.** 4 Prices as above; BUAISOU's own site. 5 Nippon Chuko's thimble guide, in Japanese; Sashiko Story's notice of 12 April 2026. 6 Upcycle Stitches, 8 June 2019 and 24 February, 20 March and 8 July 2024. 7 The same; Susan Briscoe. 8 This desk.

The economics of this craft are the strangest thing about it, because they are not a ladder. A dabbler's complete kit is **$26.50**; a committed stitcher's, with the Tulip long pack, a palm thimble, four skeins, a yard of indigo cotton and the transfer kit, is **$208.25**. A collector's is **$10,609**, of which **$7,000** is a single jacket. The money in sashiko does not buy capability; it buys other people's finished work.[1]

What the collectors buy is genuinely old cloth, and it is cheaper than the new grails. **Sri Threads**, a by-appointment gallery in Brooklyn, lists an early-20th-century boro kimono at **$595**; a long panel of plaid cotton with six patches went at **$75**. The best object in the whole file is a pair of **heavily worn, heavily stitched momohiki** — work trousers — at **$396**, reduced from $495, whose listing notes *"the sashiko stitching is dense, with a large, well-defined block of stitching on the front of each leg"*. That is the same garment type as **324 of the 786** pieces Japan protects nationally (p15), buyable for under four hundred dollars. One yukata, assembled from stitched-together souvenir towels, sells at **$165** and comes **with a loose period towel included as patch material**.[2]

Above that sits the artisan tier. **Keiko Futatsuya**'s own work is the grail: a hitomezashi jacket at **$7,000**, a nine-pattern jacket at **$5,800**, a fifteen-colour wrapping cloth at **$1,780** — all sold out. **Kiriko Made** of Portland re-cuts antique boro into product: patched scarves at **$295**, made-from-vintage robes at **$248**. And **Blue Blue Japan**'s hand-patched, naturally indigo-dyed jacket is **$765** in New York and **¥66,000** in Tokyo, both sizes gone. Commissioning is possible, but **no waitlist, deposit or lead time is published anywhere**.[3]

The dealer sells you the garment and throws in a period towel to patch it with.

The first ninety days, then, on the makers' own logic, and it does not begin with a mend. Since sashiko is stitched before damage, start on flat cloth: a Daruma panel at **$9.34** or a printed Nomura Tailor cloth at **$16.54**, and learn the running rhythm. One order, no ladder: Tulip assorted long **$9.75**, the Sashi.Co thimble **$12.50** (order it now — see the closure notice), one hand-dyed skein **$28.00**, two Olympus skeins **$16.70**, two blank cloths **$25.00**, carbon paper and mylar **$18.85**, bobbins **$2.20**, and Futatsuya's book **$26.99** — **$139.99** from two shops and a bookseller. Only then go near a garment — and patch a trouser knee, which is what three hundred and twenty-four of the protected pieces are.[4]

THE CHATTER · WHAT EXPERIENCED STITCHERS SAY BEGINNERS GET WRONG

From Futatsuya's own instruction pages, and all of it counter-intuitive. **Stop trying to make the stitches even** — his instruction is literally *"to try not to make them even"*. **Stitching through pain is not toughness:** *"the pain isn't normal"* means the technique is wrong. **Traditionally there is no knot**, and the pattern is drawn on the *"hiding"* side. The finish is wet: *"We clip all of the thread tales and loops after the stitching & putting the fabric into the water."* The glossary, briefly: **kogin**, Tsugaru work picking up an **odd** number of warp threads, giving tall diamonds; **hishizashi**, Nanbu work picking up an **even** number, giving wide ones.[5]

THE SCEPTIC · WHAT THE MENDING COMMUNITY ADMITS ABOUT ITSELF

The standing internal critique, recorded in the reference literature on visible mending, is that it resembles **"poverty cosplay"** — patched clothing having been a necessity for the poor for centuries — and that brands have taken up the aesthetic for marketing. The objects back the charge: the garments Japan protects are work trousers, worn by people legally barred from wearing cotton. And the supply chain is thinner than the boom suggests: the best-recommended thread is discontinued, the thimble's maker is closing, and a craft with **375,000** enthusiasts is supplied by a handful of small Japanese firms.[6]

$7,000

ASKING PRICE FOR ONE HITOMEZASHI JACKET BY KEIKO FUTATSUYA. THE NEEDLE THAT MAKES IT COSTS $1.63[7]

NEXT DESCENTS · VOTE FOR TOMORROW'S RABBIT HOLE

Pinball machine restoration — playfield swaps, board repair and a parts market with real grail titles.

Foraging & wild food — identification as a discipline, the legal grey zones, and a near-free hobby with a hard failure mode.

Competitive dog agility — the course, the clock and the clubs; a sport where the equipment is a dog.

SOURCES 1 This desk's arithmetic from the prices on p16 and below. 2 Sri Threads' individual product pages, each read at source — **its collection pages do not render prices.** 3 Sashiko Story, Kiriko Made, Hinoya and No Man Walks Alone. **kapital-webshop.jp and momotarojeans.com returned 403, so no price is printed for either.** 4 Prices as above. 5 Upcycle Stitches' FAQ and thimble pages; Aomori Prefecture for the odd-and-even rule. **One commonly-printed term, moyouzashi, could not be verified and is not used.** 6 The visible-mending reference literature; Sashiko Story's notices. 7 Sashiko Story; the needle figure is the Tulip long pack divided by six.

FITNESS · THE TWENTY-TWO YEAR FOLLOW-UP

The Attica cohort finds midlife starters level with the lifelong active

Published 19 October: odds of frailty after 22 years were 0.21 for the Attica adults who became active against 0.20 for the never-stopped — and 1.28, no benefit at all, for those who let it slide.

A study published on **Monday 19 October** in *The Journal of Frailty & Aging* followed **574** adults in urban Attica, Greece for **twenty-two years**, from a mean age of **48**, and then measured how frail they had become. It is the rare piece of exercise research that answers the question a forty-five-year-old actually has: not whether to start, but whether starting now is worth anything.[1]

It is. The researchers sorted people into four paths by what they reported at the start, at five years and at ten: persistently inactive, declining, rising, persistently active. Against the persistently inactive, the odds of being pre-frail or frail by 2024 were **0.20** for the persistently active — and **0.21** for those who began inactive and became active. Statistically the same answer. The people who took it up in their late forties ended where those who never stopped ended.[1]

The other arm is the warning. For those whose activity **declined** across the two decades, the odds were **1.28**, interval **0.69 to 2.38**, probability **0.432** — no measurable benefit at all. Having been fit bought nothing; keeping it bought everything. The authors put the share of pre-frailty attributable to unhealthy midlife paths at **49.5 per cent**, rising to **64.8** once blood pressure, blood sugar, cholesterol and obesity are included. Funding came from the Hellenic Cardiology and Atherosclerosis Societies. **General guidance, not medical advice.**[2]

THE CHATTER · WHAT ELSE POINTS ATTICA'S WAY THIS FORTNIGHT

No second outlet has covered the Attica paper — this desk found none — so the corroboration is a separate study in the same window. **Wong, Chen and Juan**, in *Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise* on **27 October**, tested **93 women aged 35 to 63** and found regular exercise moderated age-related slowing in reaction time, with **resistance trainers faster** than the other groups. **Cross-sectional, women only, no funding declared. Reddit, Stronger By Science and Outside all refused this desk, so no community voices appear;** this desk will not attribute lines it could not read.[3]

THE SCEPTIC · 574 OF 2,444, AND A QUESTIONNAIRE

Take the attributable fractions with real caution. **574 of 2,444 eligible participants were analysed — 23.5 per cent**; the other three-quarters were lost, and an observational sub-sample with that attrition cannot carry a causal share of 65 per cent. The exposure is a **self-reported seven-day questionnaire, dichotomised at a single threshold, three times across twenty-two years** — nothing was device-measured. The authors' own limitations list no baseline frailty assessment, merged pre-frail and frail categories so the result "*mainly reflects pre-frailty*", predefined trajectories, possible reverse causation and healthy-volunteer bias. **Dated falsifier:** a device-measured midlife cohort with data-driven trajectories and a frailty baseline.[4]

0.21 v 0.20

ODDS OF PRE-FRAILTY OR FRAILTY FOR THOSE WHO BECAME ACTIVE IN MIDLIFE, AGAINST THOSE WHO NEVER STOPPED. FOR THOSE WHO DECLINED: 1.28[1]

ALSO ON THE DESK

The muscle-mass metric the longevity scene is adopting cannot see a year of training. Devarakonda, Prado and Steven Heymsfield — the field's senior body-composition methodologist — published a critical appraisal in the *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition* on **22 October**. Only **four studies and 102 adults** have validated the current prediction model against magnetic-resonance imaging, with mean group differences from **−13.8 to +20.9 per cent**, "*lending scant support*". The single longitudinal validation, **n=14**, had limits of agreement of **±7kg** against **±1.5kg** for imaging. Their verdict: treating it as a reference standard is "*premature*".[5]

And the small muscles beat the big ones on blood pressure. A trial of **67** medicated hypertensive adults, published **1 November**, ran twelve sessions over four weeks at **30 per cent** of maximum effort. **Handgrip** training cut waking systolic pressure to **121.8 against 124.2**; **knee extension showed no effect**, and neither changed 24-hour pressure.[6]

SOURCES 1 Sgouropoulou, Kravvariti, Panagiotakos and colleagues, "Midlife physical activity trajectories are associated with reduced physical pre-frailty/frailty in older age", *The Journal of Frailty & Aging* 100217, 19 October 2026 — **full text read at source.** 2 The same paper. 3 Wong, Chen and Juan, *Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise*, 27 October. 4 The paper's own limitations; the attrition arithmetic is this desk's. 5 Devarakonda, Prado and Heymsfield, *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*, 22 October. 6 Oliveira, Waclawovsky and Lehnen, *Clinical Physiology and Functional Imaging*, 1 November.

THE DIARY · TWO DEADLINES THIS MONTH

National Gallery Singapore discounts Pop after Pop 30 per cent to 30 November

Tennis Australia's early-bird pricing for the 2027 Open ends at 12:59pm on the same day, and Tokyo's January sumo opens its advance sale on Saturday 5 December.

SINGAPORE

BOOK NOW · PLAN AHEAD

20 NOV — **wave to earth · the pieces tour**
SINGAPORE INDOOR STADIUM, 8PM · ON SALE, **NO PRICE BAND PUBLISHED** · THE KOREAN TRIO'S FIRST ARENA DATE HERE · FINE FOR A TWELVE-YEAR-OLD

20–29 Nov — ★ **Kalaa Utsavam · Indian Festival of Arts**
ESPLANADE · **40 LISTINGS, SIX FREE** · FROM **S$29**; PAATI'S SPICE KITCHEN **S$40** FOR AN ADULT AND A CHILD

28–29 Nov — **BABYMONSTER · World Tour**
INDOOR STADIUM, 6PM · **S$168–S$358 — ONE OF ONLY TWO SHOWS ON THE PROMOTER'S PAGE THAT PRINTS A BAND**

18 Nov–6 Dec — ***Eureka Day* · Singapore Repertory Theatre**
KC ARTS CENTRE · **S$48–78, UNDER-25S S$28** MIDWEEK · **NOT FOR A TWELVE-YEAR-OLD: THE THEATRE RATES IT FOR MATURE CONTENT AND COARSE LANGUAGE**

11 Dec–4 Apr — ★ **Pop after Pop · Art around Us**
NATIONAL GALLERY · FROM **S$15** RESIDENTS, **S$25** VISITORS, **S$5 OFF AGES 7–12** · WARHOL, LICHTENSTEIN, HARING, KRUGER, MING WONG — **200-PLUS WORKS, TIMED ENTRY, NO RE-ENTRY** · **30 PER CENT OFF TO 30 NOV**

29–30 Jan — **Kenshi Yonezu · GHOST**
INDOOR STADIUM, TWO NIGHTS · ON SALE, **NO PRICE PUBLISHED** · JAPAN'S BIGGEST SONGWRITER, AND SINGAPORE IS THE REGIONAL STOP

JAPAN & THE REGION

WORTH THE FLIGHT

to 28 Mar — ★ **Mariko Mori · All That Shines**
MORI ART MUSEUM, ROPPONGI HILLS · **¥2,600–3,000** ADULTS, **JUNIOR HIGH AND UNDER FREE** · OPEN DAILY TO **22:00** · **TIMED ENTRY, AND THE WAVE UFO SLOTS ARE LIMITED — BOOK THE SLOT, NOT THE DAY**

to 31 Jan — **Edo Paintings That Crossed the Seas**
OSAKA NAKANOSHIMA MUSEUM OF ART · **¥2,100 ADVANCE, ¥2,300 DOOR, ¥300 FOR PRIMARY AND JUNIOR HIGH** · ABOUT 200 WORKS ON LOAN BACK FROM THE BRITISH MUSEUM · **IT WILL NOT SELL AN ADVANCE TICKET AT THE DOOR**

11–31 Jan — ★ **Australian Open 2027 · Melbourne Park**
GROUND PASSES FROM **A$49**; OPENING WEEK **CHILDREN A$5, FREE MONDAY 11 JAN** · DIGITAL TICKETS ONLY · **EARLY-BIRD PRICING ENDS 12:59PM, 30 NOVEMBER** — THE ONE ENTRY HERE WHERE PRINTING IT CHANGES WHAT A READER PAYS

10–24 Jan — **Hatsu Basho · January Grand Sumo**
RYŌGOKU KOKUGIKAN, TOKYO · **ADVANCE SALES OPEN SATURDAY 5 DECEMBER**; JANUARY PRICES NOT YET POSTED · **BOXES SELL ONLY AS A WHOLE BOX OF FOUR, AND EVERY TICKET CARRIES ¥2,000 PLUS ¥550 IN FEES**

PLANNING NOTES

Two deadlines fall on 30 November. The National Gallery's 30 per cent discount on Pop after Pop dies that day and is applied automatically at checkout; the Australian Open's early-bird pricing ends at **12:59pm**. Both were read on the venue's and the park's own pages. If this page is read for one thing, read it for those.

Sumo is a calendar problem, not a ticket problem. Tokyo's January tournament opens its advance sale on **Saturday 5 December**; miss the Saturday and you are into resale. Three traps: box seats sell **only as a whole box of four**, so a couple pays for four; a child needs a ticket from **age four**; and ringside, at **¥20,000** a head, cannot be bought on the English site at all.

Both marathons are shut — spectate, do not enter. Singapore's December race closed entries at **23:59 on 31 October**; Tokyo's 7 March edition ran its ballot in August. **And the November sumo in Fukuoka is sold out on all fifteen days with no door sales.**

Three things this desk will not print. Christmas Wonderland's 2026 dates, because the organiser's pages still render empty template placeholders five weeks out; the Sapporo Snow Festival's 2027 dates, because its own site still shows 2025; and a Singapore run of *Moulin Rouge!*, because the rights-holder's world-tour page lists the West End, Hamburg, Sydney and Japan — not Singapore. **Marina Bay Sands, its theatre agency and one of the two big ticketing sites all refused this desk.**

SOURCES 1 Every Singapore entry read on the promoter's or venue's own page, 2 November 2026: Live Nation Singapore's two venue pages, esplanade.com, srt.com.sg, and the National Gallery's exhibition page and media release. 2 Every Japan and region entry read at its official site: mori.art.museum, the Osaka Nakanoshima listing, the official sumo portal and its fee schedule, and melbournepark.com.au's 2027 guide. 3 Closures at source: singaporeinternationalmarathon.com and marathon.tokyo. **Christmas Wonderland, the Sapporo Snow Festival, Singapore Art Week 2027, the Australian Grand Prix date and a Singapore Moulin Rouge! run are all unverifiable at source and are not listed.**

THE TABLE · FOUR NEW ROOMS

SHAO opens a fourth Singapore restaurant at Dempsey Hill, still unreviewed

Mr. CHEESECAKE brings its first Southeast Asian pop-up to ION from 11 November at S$62 to S$69 a cake, and a London counter arrives at New Bahru the same day.

Four rooms opened or are about to open in Singapore, and the honest verdict on every one of them is the same: too new to call. This desk checked the local food press, the guides and the social channels for each, and found no review of any. That is worth saying plainly rather than borrowing praise from a sibling branch, which is the usual way this page goes wrong.[1]

SHAO has taken a unit at Dempsey Hill — its fourth Singapore restaurant after Frankel, Holland Village and Rangoon Road — doing contemporary Teochew with marinated roe crab and pan-seared Hokkaido cuttlefish in squid ink. No chef is named in any source this desk could read, and no prices are published for the Dempsey room. The only reception that exists belongs to the older branches, and it is useful: an independent reviewer scored Rangoon Road **4 out of 5**, calling the braised combination platter the standout, and the Holland Village tapas room **3 out of 5**, noting that *"from the outside, the dark decor does not look like a typical Teochew restaurant"*. Service is the recurring soft spot across both, not the cooking. Book a table and ask for the roe crab when you book; it is the dish both write-ups single out.[2]

Mr. CHEESECAKE, the cult Tokyo brand, runs its **first Southeast Asian pop-up** at ION Orchard from **11 November to 30 December** — whole cakes only, at **S$62** for the original, **S$69** for matcha and **S$69** for sake-lees coconut. Two publications list different flavour line-ups and one says the price is still to be announced, so treat the range as fixed and the flavours as fluid. It is a whole-cake counter in a mall through the gifting season: go in the first week and treat it as a pre-order, because by mid-December the Christmas trade owns it. And **Bomul Samgyetang** has opened a second outlet at Scotts Square, basement one — the Korean ginseng-chicken-soup specialist, open daily 11am to 10pm, with sets from **S$79**, the soup itself from **S$29** and knife-cut noodles from **S$19**. No chef is named. A second outlet is the clearest new peg this page has, and it is still the only one of the four with a trading record behind it.[3]

THE BUZZ · WHAT IS ACTUALLY KNOWN ABOUT THESE FOUR

BFF — Bao Fast Foods, from the London group founded by Shing Tat Chung, Erchen Chang and Wai Ting Chung, which began as a stall at Netil Market and now has seven London sites — opens its Singapore pop-up at **New Bahru** on **11 November**, running to **28 December**, **daily 11am to 10pm and shut on Tuesdays**. The chicken chopper is **S$6.50** in three finishes, dan dan noodles **S$6.50**, a rice box from **S$7.95**. Honeycombers has published the listing and says plainly, *"We'll be back with a review of Bao Fast Foods' pop-up at New Bahru soon"* — so there is no verdict yet, only a recommendation to try the chopper in every flavour. The hook is what it is for: the pop-up is a testbed for a **permanent Singapore outlet in early 2027**. No reservations; it is a counter.[4]

THE SCEPTIC · FOUR OPENINGS, NOUGHT REVIEWS

Everything above is an announcement. Not one of these four rooms has been eaten in and written up by anyone this desk could read, and three of the sources are listings pages compiled from press releases. Two further cautions. **Reddit, Burpple and the big local food site all refused this desk**, so the social layer that would normally temper a press listing is simply absent from this page — and that absence is why nothing here is called good. And one venue that appears in this month's roundups was struck from the page on checking: a pasta room carried as an October opening in fact opened on **17 May 2025** and is in the list for a new lunch buffet, which is not an opening at all.[5]

TOO NEW TO CALL · POP-UP, DATED · NO RESERVATIONS · DEMPSEY

0 of 4

OF THIS MONTH'S FOUR SINGAPORE OPENINGS THAT ANY PUBLICATION HAS YET REVIEWED. THE PAGE SAYS SO RATHER THAN INVENTING A VERDICT[1]

SOURCES 1 This desk's own check, 2 November 2026, across the local food press, the guides and the social channels for each of the four. 2 TheSmartLocal's November 2026 roundup for the Dempsey unit, address and dishes; Ordinary Patrons' dated reviews of the Rangoon Road and Holland Village branches, both read at source. **burpple.com and alvinology.com returned 403.** 3 Eatbook's November 2026 listing for the pop-up dates, unit and three prices; TheSmartLocal for the conflicting flavour list and its "price to be announced"; Honeycombers' October listing for the Scotts Square unit, hours and prices. 4 Honeycombers' listing, read in full, including its founders, full price list, opening hours, the Tuesday closure, the no-reservations line, the early-2027 plan and its own statement that no review exists yet. 5 This desk. **sethlui.com returned 403 site-wide and Reddit is unreachable, so no forum or Instagram sentiment appears anywhere on this page.**

THE UNDERCURRENT · BENTENG BIGAS, MERON NA

The Philippines sells rice at twenty pesos and lifts the market price

Rice inflation reached 20.3 per cent in September, and 23.6 for the poorest third of households. A record 961,346 Filipinos queued for the twenty-peso ration.

In September, **961,346** Filipinos bought rice from their government at **twenty pesos a kilo** — a programme record, beating April's 838,695, and amounting to **21.4 million kilos**. In the same month, the price of rice in Philippine shops rose **20.3 per cent** year on year, and for the poorest **thirty per cent** of households, **23.6**. Both facts are the work of the same government, and the second is not a failure of the first. It is the other half of the design.[1]

The programme is called **"Benteng Bigas, Meron Na!"** — Tagalog for "twenty-peso rice, we've got it now"; *bente* from the Spanish *veinte*, *bigas* the inherited Austronesian word for husked, uncooked rice. The initials spell BBM, which is also President Ferdinand Marcos Jr's own nickname. It sells milled rice through government outlets at twenty pesos to listed categories of buyer — pensioners, the disabled, solo parents, the indigent, farmers, fisherfolk, minimum-wage earners — thirty kilos a month, and from December in a single transaction.[1]

Two prices for the same grain, set by the same hand, and the gap between them is the policy.

Meanwhile the state is working, deliberately and successfully, to raise the price everybody else pays. It is doing so because it cannot do the obvious thing. A 2024 executive order cut the rice tariff from 35 to **15 per cent** and holds it there until 2028, and the agriculture department says plainly that changing it is not in its gift. So it reaches instead for an instrument with no rate, no schedule and no published series: the **sanitary and phytosanitary import clearance**, issued ship by ship by the Bureau of Plant Industry. Grant it, ration it, target it by origin or by grade — or cancel it while the vessel is at sea.[2]

On **14 September** the MV *Tay Son 2* docked at Davao carrying **12,480 tonnes** of Vietnamese rice — "*about one-third of the country's daily rice requirement of 37,000*" tonnes, in the national news agency's own phrasing. The department had already ordered the clearance cancelled, in Secretary **Francisco Tiu Laurel Jr's** words, "*even though the vessel was already on its way*", because the cargo was the premium five-per-cent-broken grade that importers had agreed in July to stop bringing in. The captain refused inspection. On **17 September** the ship sailed, and **the Philippine Navy intercepted it off Sarangani** and brought it to General Santos.[3]

A warship was sent after twelve thousand tonnes of perfectly good rice, because a form had been withdrawn.

The grade ban is real and it is narrow: since July the trade has agreed to import nothing finer than twenty-five-per-cent-broken rice, which is to say the state has taken a view on the quality of the national staple and not merely its quantity. There is no general ban — the secretary said in August, plainly, "*we will not suspend imports*" — but there is a port closed at Iloilo to the end of this month, a grade barred since July, and clearances cancelled one ship at a time.[3]

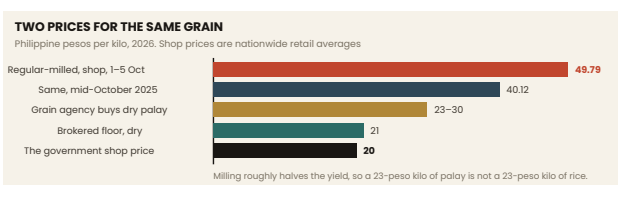
Then the part that makes the policy legible. The Bureau of Customs proposed auctioning the seized cargo. Tiu Laurel refused — "*I am not in favour of auctioning this*" — on the reported grounds that a sale could let those behind the shipment profit, and recommended giving it instead to the social welfare department, citing confiscated fish as the precedent. Read the two decisions together. The state would not let twelve thousand tonnes of cheap premium rice reach a Philippine market, and would rather give it away than sell it. The thing being protected is the price.[4]

SOURCES 1 BusinessWorld, 1 November 2026, via Rice News Today, and PhilStar, 1 November, agreeing on every figure; the statistics authority's September release as carried by the *Daily Tribune*, 6 October, and GMA. **psa.gov.ph refused this desk on every path, so every statistics-authority figure is read on a page quoting the release.** 2 Executive Order 62 of 2024 as described by the agriculture department and the *BusinessMirror*, 28 October. 3 Philippine News Agency, 14 October, read in full, and the department's release of the same date; its releases of 4 August and 3 July and the *Daily Tribune* of 18 July for the import status. **A reported origin-specific halt could not be verified and is not printed.** 4 *Daily Tribune*, 17 and 18 October. **The widely-quoted phrase about "people who want to profit from it" appears in neither; only the one quotation above is direct.**

The machine has eight moving parts, and it is worth setting them out in order, because each one is defensible and the assembly is not. **One:** the tariff is locked at 15 per cent until 2028 and the agriculture department cannot change it. **Two:** so the quantity is controlled instead, through a clearance that must be issued for every commercial shipment and that the department decides when, whether and to whom to grant. **Three:** the grade is controlled too — from July 2026 importers agreed to stop bringing in five-per-cent-broken premium rice and to import only coarser grades. The state is managing the quality of the national staple, not merely its volume.[1]

Four: a floor price for unmilled rice is negotiated rather than legislated. On 22 January traders assured the department they would keep buying at a minimum of **17 pesos a kilo wet and 21 dry**, even as imports arrived, and the grain agency undertook not to compete with them while they held it. **Five:** the agency then buys above its own brokered floor — an academic briefing from the Ateneo economics association puts its dry-palay purchases at **23 to 30 pesos** and notes that milling "*roughly halves the yield, effectively doubling the production costs*". **Six:** it sells the result at twenty. The gap is the subsidy, and nobody publishes it.[2]

Seven: enforcement is physical, as the *Tay Son 2* showed. **Eight** — and this is the part that makes it a system rather than an episode — the loop feeds itself. Steps two to five raise the market price; the higher the market price, the wider the twenty-peso gap; the wider the gap, the longer the queue. September's record of **961,346** buyers is not evidence that the programme is working. It is evidence that the shop price has moved out of reach. The programme's cost is an increasing function of the policy that makes it popular.[2]



A *Meridian* original, from the Manila Times' report of the agriculture department's retail series and the Ateneo economics association's briefing.[3]

What makes this an argument rather than a complaint is the absence at the centre of it. **No register, series or dataset of clearance issuances, refusals or volumes appears anywhere on the agriculture department's public site**, including its own transparency page, where the clearance surfaces only in press announcements and never as data. Tariffs are legible: they are printed in an executive order, reported to trading partners, modelled by economists, argued over in Geneva. A queue at a clearance desk is legible to nobody. And on **28 October** the department said it would point the same instrument at pork, suspending clearances for selected cuts from mid-November to January — again because it cannot raise the tariff.[4]

The cost of that gap is the number the state does not give. An academic briefing applies a World Bank cost multiplier and arrives at a true cost of **172 pesos** for every twenty-peso kilo — a figure this desk prints as the briefing's, not as a fact, because no government document contains anything comparable. The published figures are beneficiary counts and kilos. A parliamentary report of June 2025 put an institutionalised programme at about **140 million pesos a day, roughly 51.1 billion a year** — an estimate of a cost nobody has yet stated.[6]

5.6m

TONNES OF RICE THE PHILIPPINES IS FORECAST TO IMPORT IN 2026-27, THE LARGEST OF ANY COUNTRY — AHEAD OF VIETNAM'S 3.6M AND CHINA'S 3.5M[5]

Which matters well beyond Manila, because the Philippines is the largest rice importer on earth. The United States Department of Agriculture's October circular forecasts Philippine imports of **5.6 million tonnes** in 2026-27, ahead of Vietnam's 3.6 and China's 3.5, and calls the country Vietnam's "*leading export market*". When Manila stops issuing clearances, the world rice price hears about it. A single-market trade association in India recorded Vietnamese export prices falling to a near-three-year low during the 2025 suspension. Singapore, which imports essentially all of its rice, sits directly downstream of that desk.[5]

SOURCES 1 The agriculture department's releases of 22 January and 3 July 2026 and PhilStar, 3 July; the *BusinessMirror*, 28 October, on the tariff constraint. 2 The 22 January release for the brokered floor — **single-sourced to the department, with no confirmation it was honoured**; the Ateneo de Manila economics association's briefing for the purchase band and the milling ratio. **A widely-repeated 38-peso true cost could not be verified and is not printed.** 3 Manila Times, 19 October, reporting the department's retail series for 1–5 October and its year-earlier comparators; the Ateneo briefing. **A circulating 56.22-peso well-milled figure is contradicted by the department's own daily index.** 4 This desk's search of the department's transparency page and site, 2 November. **The Bureau of Plant Industry's own site could not be opened, so the claim is confined to the department's material.** 5 The United States Department of Agriculture's *Grain: World Markets and Trade*, October 2026, **read at source**; the Indian Rice Exporters Federation. 6 The Ateneo briefing — **its 172-peso figure is its own arithmetic on a World Bank multiplier, attributed, not adopted**; a parliamentary report of 2 June 2025, where 51.1 billion appears as an "initial estimate".

Japan ran this machine for fifty-three years, and the Philippine state should read the ending. The Food Control Act of **1942** had farmers sell set quantities to the government at set prices, with consumer prices set separately. The government's purchase price exceeded its selling price — the 逆ざや, *gyakuzaya* or "reverse margin" — **until 1986**, when Tokyo finally cut what it paid. The resulting deficits were nicknamed the "three-K deficit" in parliamentary debate; the losses from disposing of surplus rice in the 1970s and early 1980s have been estimated above **three trillion yen**. The law was repealed on **1 November 1995**.[1]

Forty-four years to close the reverse margin; fifty-three to repeal the act. That is the long account a two-price state opens, and it is why the honest question about Manila is not whether the subsidy is affordable this year. The programme is funded to **30 June 2028** — the end of the presidential term.[1]

What a state measures, it manages. What it declines to measure, it can keep doing.

There is a second precedent, and the Philippines was on the other side of it. In the 2008 global rice crisis the international price rose from about **300 to 1,200 dollars a tonne** between January and May, with no physical shortage, as India, Vietnam, Egypt, Pakistan and Brazil restricted exports in turn. The Philippines, then as now the world's largest importer, convened an emergency meeting on **15 April 2008** to object, and its agriculture secretary, **Arthur Yap**, said: "*Free trade should be flowing.*" Eighteen years later the same ministry is cancelling clearances to keep rice out.[2]

The case against this reading deserves its hearing, and it is arithmetical. Twenty-one point four million kilos in the record month is about **1.5 per cent** of the roughly 1.47 million tonnes Filipinos eat each month, and a channel that small cannot set a price. The government's own account of September's inflation is different: the planning secretary, **Arsenio Balisacan**, attributed it mainly to "*disruptions in food supply caused by adverse weather*" and higher global oil prices. A peso at a record **64.17** to the dollar on 27 October, and a central bank that raised rates **fifty basis points to 5.50 per cent** on 22 October, are doing work no rice policy explains. Governor **Eli Remolona** was explicit: "*We're not hiking the policy rate to defend the peso.*"[3]

But the defence concedes the argument. If the twenty-peso channel is too small to move the price, then it is not a food-security programme with an electoral side-effect; it is an electoral instrument with a food-security justification, and its monthly beneficiary count is the most honest poll the Philippines publishes. The thesis is narrower than "the subsidy is expensive": **when a state's visible trade instruments are locked, protection does not disappear — it becomes invisible.** A tariff can be negotiated down because it can be counted. A clearance queue cannot, because there is nothing to put on the table. The Association of Southeast Asian Nations measures tariffs. This is what its single market cannot see — and from mid-November it will be doing it to pork.[4]

THE CHATTER · WHAT FILIPINOS SAY AT THE TWENTY-PESO WINDOW

From a report on the queues in Cebu City, in the speakers' own English. **Noel Gallado**, of San Roque, living on a pension: "*Everything is expensive now. Rice alone can reach P70 per kilo. It's really difficult.*" **Sonia Olmoguez**, also of San Roque, doing odd jobs: "*We just make do with what we have. The P20 rice helps, but only just enough.*" **Mary Jane Sode**, of Sto. Niño, on the thirty-kilo allocation: "*This might last a week, but what about the next?*" On the farmers' side, **Raul Montemayor** of the Federation of Free Farmers, on those who held their harvest waiting for a ban to lift prices: "*Unfortunately, that backfired. Instead of rising, prices fell even further.*"[5]

THE SCEPTIC · THE NUMBERS THIS DESK WOULD NOT PRINT

Four figures circulate widely on this subject and are not in this essay, because they could not be read at source. A **38-peso** true cost per kilo, from a publication that refused every path offered it. A **56.22-peso** well-milled retail price, contradicted by the agriculture department's own daily index at **48.72**. A **6.84-to-one** World Bank leakage ratio dated 2012, whose nearest real relative is a 2020 working paper. And two economists' quotations, attributed confidently across the internet, that no page this desk could open contains. On an essay about a state that will not publish its numbers, the discipline runs both ways.[6]

SOURCES 1 Japan's Food Control Act, Law No. 40 of 1942, repealed 1 November 1995, and the Food Control Special Account, **read in Japanese at source** — the reverse margin to 1986, the "three-K" nickname and the estimate above three trillion yen; the funding horizon from PhilStar, 5 September 2026. 2 The 2008 global rice crisis, read at source, including the 15 April meeting and Yap's remark. 3 Monthly consumption and the import comparison from the People's Coalition on Food Sovereignty — **an advocacy source, flagged**; Balisacan via GMA, 6 October; the peso record and rate decision from the *Daily Tribune*, 22, 23 and 27 October. 4 This desk; the pork measure from the *BusinessMirror*. 5 SunStar Cebu, 30 March 2026, every quotation as the paper printed it; *Daily Tribune*, 2 July 2025, for Montemayor. 6 This desk's verification pass.

THE LAST WORD

The long account

A company five years old told the American share regulator on Monday it has promised suppliers eight hundred and ninety-five point four billion dollars, the last of it falling due in the year two thousand and forty-five (p7). It has earned thirty-three billion. Nineteen years is a long time to be good for a number, and the document that names it still has a blank where the price of a share goes.

Elsewhere in the issue the same shape keeps turning up, with the clock set differently. A patch letting any brand of graphics card share one model took a hundred and twenty-nine days to merge, and a robot closed the request as inactive the day before it shipped (p8). A band reached number one twenty years and four months after its first chart entry, the longest wait that chart has recorded (p11). Singapore's haze law has been invoked twice in twelve years and produced no fine; the power to compel reaches Parliament today, after the companies had already agreed (p5). And an axe is sold with twenty years on the steel and nothing on the handle, because the steel outlives the owner and the wood does not (p6).

The cover of this issue is cloth that was mended for a century by people forbidden to wear cotton, and the country that once threw it away now protects seven hundred and eighty-six pieces of it (p15). Which is the other half of a long account: you cannot tell, while you are paying into one, whether you are servicing a debt or building an inheritance. Manila cannot either. It sells rice at twenty pesos, works to raise the price of everyone else's, and has funded the difference precisely to the thirtieth of June, two thousand and twenty-eight — the last day of the president's term (p21).

TWELVE DESKS · ONE WORLD

MERIDIAN · No. 152 · 3 November 2026

A note on method. This edition's load-bearing documents were read where they are published. Anthropic's registration statement and its amendment, and four other filings, were **downloaded in full from the Securities and Exchange Commission's own system and compared line by line**; the United States Treasury's daily par and real yield curves supplied both yield lines on **p14**; three Singapore ministries were read at source; two Japanese government databases supplied the sashiko designation, in Japanese; six journals, two code repositories and a model card were read at source; and every dated event on **p19** was read on the venue's or promoter's own page. **One correction to No. 151 runs on p7.** Where a host refused us — **Reddit for the nineteenth issue running, so there is no Reddit sentiment anywhere in this book; also Billboard, the Philippine Statistics Authority, BusinessWorld, the Straits Times, Marina Bay Sands, Bladeforums, Burpple, HardwareZone and sinn.de** — the page says so rather than quietly substituting. **Four figures that circulate widely on the Long Read's subject are named on p23 and left out, because they could not be read at source. Every photograph in this issue was downloaded and looked at before it was captioned.**